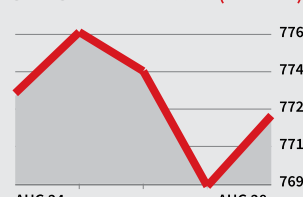


the hindu businessline

SENSEX 77264.51 (+330.92)



IN FOCUS

	LATEST	CHANGE
Nifty 50	24175.65	+84.80
P/E Ratio (Sensex)	20.47	+0.09
US Dollar (in ₹)	95.37	-0.17
Gold Std 10 gm (in ₹)	158939.00	+1187
Silver 1 kg (in ₹)	243892.00	+4392

GROWTH PLAY.

Sandhya Devanathan, Meta’s India and Southeast Asia head, joins OpenAI as VP for Southeast Asia and Australia **p10**



AUTO FOCUS.

Land Rover Defender Trophy Edition revives Camel Trophy spirit with striking looks **p4**

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

RNI No. UPENG/2022/86886

QUICKLY.

ENERGY SHIFT

Renewables generated one-fifth of power in July



New Delhi: Renewables accounted for a record 20 per cent or one-fifth of the country's cumulative power generation during July. The timing of this feat matters, considering that India's power demand surged by almost 11 per cent y-o-y last month to around 171 billion units — the highest on record for any month. For comparison, in July 2025, power demand grew a mere 2.6 per cent. **p3**

MANDATE CHANGE

Govt to issue fortnightly sugar sale quota for mills

New Delhi: The Centre on Friday announced a change in the mill-wise quota allocation system for sugar sales in the domestic market by introducing it on a fortnightly basis from September, replacing the monthly quota system. The government also stipulated that every mill will have to sell at least 40 per cent of the fortnightly allocation in the first week and the remaining in the following week. **p8**

Jio Platforms gets SEBI nod for a record ₹37,700-crore IPO

BIG FLOAT. IPO comprises fresh issue of 27 crore shares, with no offer-for-sale component

Vallari Sanzgiri
Mumbai

Reliance Industries’ digital arm Jio Platforms on Friday received SEBI’s nod to float India’s largest-ever initial public offer of about ₹37,700 crore.

The company received the observation letter on the Draft Red Herring Prospectus filed for its proposed IPO from the market regulator, clearing the path for Jio to move ahead with its listing plans. The company reported a consolidated net profit of ₹30,064 crore on revenues of ₹1.49 lakh crore in FY26.

NO OFFER FOR SALE

As per the company’s DRHP, Jio’s offering comprises a fresh issue of 27 crore equity shares with a face value of ₹10 each and has no offer-for-sale component, indicating existing investors’ inclination not to exit from the company during listing. The company’s existing investors include companies like Google, Meta and Silver Lake. While the IPO’s net proceeds will be largely used for repayment of outstand-



GROWTH SPURT. In the latest quarter, Jio’s telecom arm reported robust performance, with continued subscriber additions, modest ARPU improvement and record-high EBITDA margins

ing debt, analysts remain bullish on the IPO’s ability to attract investor interest.

“Jio has strong cash flows, and coming back with a listing allows them a more focused approach going ahead. They might clear debt, but as the opportunity arises, they have levers and leverage to raise equity and debt if needed,” said Kranthi Bathini, Director of Equity Strategy at WealthMills Securities.

Brokerages estimate a capital raise between ₹33,000 crore and ₹38,000 crore as against the borrowings of ₹27,500 crore, leaving

the company with only ₹5,500-10,500 crore for other corporate needs. Debt repayment will also drastically bring down interest cost by ₹2,000-2,500 crore, as per Deven Choksey of DRChoksey Finserv.

MARKET IMPACT

Regarding the market impact, Choksey said, “Assuming a listing market-cap of ₹13-14 lakh crore, Jio will rank among the first 5 listed companies in the country and attract a lot of investors. Listing also raises the company’s growth programme to a much bigger scale. Growing

at 20 per cent, Jio’s market-cap may reach ₹20 lakh crore in 2-3 years. This is at par with Reliance Industries’ current market cap.”

At the same time, Shriram Subramanian, Founder of proxy advisory firm InGovern, pointed out that Jio’s listing, by itself, will not lead to a holding-company discount for RIL. The parent company, though traditionally dependent on petrochemicals and oil and gas businesses, now holds a more diversified business mix, with retail and telecom making significant contributions to revenue and profit.

Jio’s IPO may also bring favourable tides to India’s data centre segment, wherein a few other players like Sify and ESDS Software Solutions have tried for IPOs, said Yugal Joshi, Partner at Everest Group.

In the latest quarter, Jio’s telecom arm reported robust performance, with continued subscriber additions, modest ARPU improvement and record-high EBITDA margins. EBITDA grew by 15 per cent to ₹20,865 crore, with margins expanding 150 basis points.

Industrial growth slowed to 6.7% in July, dragged by mining sector

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

India’s industrial output expansion eased to 6.7 per cent in July, down from 7.3 per cent in June, despite manufacturing holding firm.

Analysts suggest that overall growth could hit 8 per cent this fiscal, contingent on a strong festival season rebound.

MANUFACTURING LEADS

According to the National Statistics Office, the July headline number was “supported by 7.3 per cent growth in the manufacturing sector and strong growth of 8.7 per cent in the electricity and gas supply sector”.

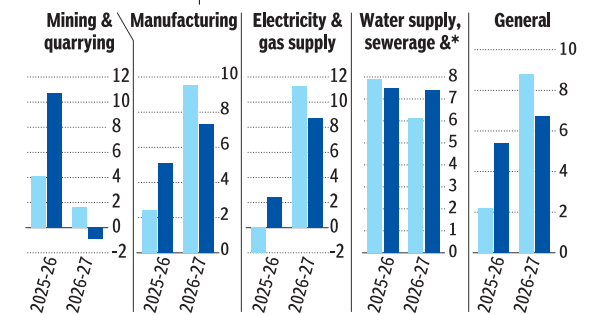
The data showed that the mining and quarrying sector contracted by 0.9 per cent in July against 10.7 per cent growth a year ago.

In the manufacturing sector, 19 out of 23 industry groups recorded a positive year-on-year growth in July.

“July IIP data confirms that growth momentum in the economy remains strong,” said Rajni Thakur, Chief Economist, L&T Finance.

Further, she highlighted that 16 per cent growth in capital goods production, 10 per cent growth in interme-

Growth snapshot



Source: MoSPI All figures in%, Base: 2022-23=100 *waste management

diate goods, and 11 per cent growth in consumer durables production reflected a broad-based strength in industrial activity in the country.

Rajeev Sharan, Head of Research, Brickwork Ratings, noted that consumer durables, the big-ticket items such as vehicles and appliances, grew 10.5 per cent, while everyday goods such as food and toiletries fell 1 per cent. The same split runs through factory output, with motor vehicles up 22.2 per cent and electrical equipment up 28.3 per cent, against 2.6 per cent for food products and a 0.6 per cent fall in clothing.

“This suggests discretionary and credit-linked purchases remain strong, while everyday items, more closely tied to rural incomes and real

wages, remain weak,” he said.

GROWTH DRIVER

Growth in the coming months will depend on festival demand.

Madan Sabnavis, Chief Economist, Bank of Baroda, stated that for the four months, growth was driven by manufacturing at 7 per cent and electricity at 8.7 per cent. However, the mining sector was depressed at -1.1 per cent, which can be attributed partly to the monsoon effect. Interestingly, the rare earths category registered growth of over 20 per cent, though from a small base.

“For the year ahead, IIP growth could be in the region of 7-8 per cent,” he said, “especially if the festival demand is retained this year as it was last year.”

Subhash Chandra disputes ‘haircut’, says most of Group’s debts repaid; ‘plans to go to Switzerland’

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Zee Group Founder Subhash Chandra, in a video message on Friday, challenged the allegations of financial swindling against him, and aired plans to visit Switzerland in the coming weeks.

“For the past two days, I have been clubbed with people from this country who have swindled the financial system, taken the money, and bought palaces and ships for themselves. [In 2019,] I wrote an open letter to the country’s banking system admitting my mistakes. I said I and the borrowing entities from my group will pay the entire system’s money and we did that,” said Chandra in the message in Hindi.

The media baron was speaking in the context of the the National Company



Zee Group Founder Subhash Chandra

Law Tribunal’s decision to allow Chandra’s repayment plan of only ₹6.5 crore against admitted claims of over ₹22,000 crore. The news had garnered strong reactions, especially from lenders such as HDFC Bank, which said it was mulling the possibility of appealing to the Appellate Tribunal.

PAID SUM & THEN SOME Chandra argued that the

company had already repaid about ₹43,000 crore of the ₹45,000 crore total outstanding, with the remaining amount pending due to complications in the asset liabilities of other companies.

“I had signed some personal guarantees to some lenders. Even some lenders whose entire money was repaid have entered their claim in the NCLT. It shouldn’t have happened,” said Chandra, adding that he must have paid at least ₹70,000 crore to the financial system in his working life.

Chandra on Friday also accused media channels of Mukesh Ambani of spreading inaccurate figures related to claims. He stated that he had written to Ambani regarding the same.

Later, the Reliance Group responded to the accusations “with dismay” and strongly denied the allega-

tions and insinuations against the media entities.

Speaking about the future, Chandra said he planned to meet “a friend in Switzerland” within the next two weeks for help in “investment work”.

“I will see his investment in India and other places so that I can re-establish myself,” he added.

He also dismissed claims of huge personal wealth as a “myth”, arguing that in 2016, he had declared his personal wealth to be ₹39.70 crore.

“So, how will it become ₹45,000 crore in 2017,” he asked, adding that the Finance Minister and the Banking Secretary should do an independent audit.

In a separate statement, Chandra also dismissed claims that the companies in favour of the repayment plan were associate entities.

Also read p2

CROWNING GLORY



FROM TRAILING TO TRIUMPH. Grandmaster R Praggnanandhaa became the first Indian to clinch the Grand Chess Tour Title, beating Fabiano Caruana of the US, at the GCT 2026 in St Louis, US. Praggnanandhaa made a turnaround after trailing Caruana at the start of day. He prevailed over Caruana 15-13 to win his maiden GCT Title and pocket \$2,00,000 as the winning purse **Report on p10** PTI

TVS Motor Company picks French automotive veteran Peyman Kargar as the next CEO

Sindhu Hariharan
Chennai

French automotive executive Peyman Kargar is set to become the new CEO of India’s third-largest two-wheeler maker, TVS Motor Company, just 17 months after joining the company as the President of its International Division.

TVS Motor Company announced the appointment of Kargar as Director and Chief Executive Officer, effective January 27, 2027. He will succeed KN Radhakrishnan, who will continue in his role until January 2027 and then become a Non-Executive Director until the date of the ensuing AGM in July 2027.

Radhakrishnan took charge as CEO and President in 2008.

GLOBAL EXPERIENCE

With over three decades of experience across global car companies spanning Europe,

Asia, Africa and the Middle East, Kargar will help TVS Motor in its key focus areas of premiumisation, global expansion, and product innovation. His reputation as a turnaround specialist, along with a global footprint cutting across product development, R&D, manufacturing and sales functions, makes Kargar a valuable addition to TVS Motor in its next phase of growth.

With an engineering degree from INSA Lyon in France and an MBA from London Business School, Kargar was most recently the Global Chairman and President of Infiniti, the luxury brand of Nissan. His previous roles include Vice-President of Sales and Marketing at the Renault Group, as well as Managing Director of Renault Middle East and Country Manager in Iran.

Kargar’s elevation to TVS’s top role also stems from the automaker’s strong interna-



Peyman Kargar

tional business performance. Overseas markets now make up almost a third of the sales and are growing at over 30 per cent.

CHALLENGE AHEAD

Kranti Bathini, Director of Equity Strategy at WealthMills Securities, said that Kargar’s immediate challenge will be to sustain the double-digit growth from a base of nearly six million vehicles while protecting the margins during an investment-heavy transition to EVs. “The benchmark is high because of what Radhakrishnan leaves behind. During his

tenure, TVS Motor strengthened domestic market share, accelerated exports and premiumisation and built electric and global platforms.”

Sudarshan Venu, Chairman, TVS Motor, said, “Peyman is an accomplished leader with profound industry experience. I am confident he is the right person to lead TVS Motor Company and strengthen our position.”

Interestingly, his brother Keyvan Kargar is also an automotive and industrial electronics veteran with stints in the Forvia Group and Renault, among others.

Peyman has dedicated his career to the industry, leading businesses, transforming organisations and bringing people together around a shared ambition, Keyvan said in a post on LinkedIn on Friday.

With inputs from Amit Vijay Mohile in Mumbai

QUICKLY.

Govt to buy back ₹30,000 cr securities on September 3

Mumbai: The Reserve Bank of India on Friday announced the buyback of government securities worth ₹30,000 crore on September 3. The auction will take place on September 3, between 10.30 am and 11.30 am on the Reserve Bank of India Core Banking Solution (E-Kuber), the RBI said in a notification. The government will buy back securities such as 7.33 per cent GS 2026, 5.74 per cent GS 2026, 8.15 per cent GS 2026, and 8.24 per cent GS 2027, the notification said. **PH**

Union Bank of India raises \$600 million from bonds

New Delhi: State-owned Union Bank of India has raised \$600 million from bonds issued to overseas investors to fund business growth. The fund raised by issuing USD REG S Senior Unsecured Dual Tranche Notes due 2029 (3 years) and 2031 (5 years) of \$300 million each issued through Union Bank of India Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC) branch, the bank said in a regulatory filing on Friday. These bonds would be listed at NSE IFSC Ltd, it said. **PH**

Renewables produced one-fifth of the power generated in July

ENERGY SHIFT. Power demand surged 11% y-o-y last month to 171 billion units; share of coal slipped

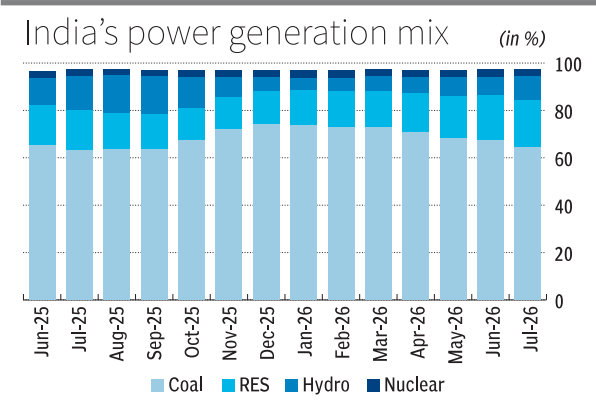
Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

In a significant development that further strengthens India's green energy push, renewables accounted for a record 20 per cent or one-fifth of the country's cumulative power generation during July.

The timing of this feat also matters considering India's power demand surged by almost 11 per cent y-o-y last month to roughly 171 billion units (BU) — the highest on record for any month. For comparison, in July 2025, power demand grew a mere 2.6 per cent.

July also witnessed a peak power demand of 270 GW, only the second-highest ever on record. Crisil Intelligence said this is around 22 per cent higher than the peak of 221 GW seen in the same month last year.

Another interesting development was that even as the



country's 224 GW of thermal power capacity burned more coal during July to cater to the rising demand for cooling, the share of coal in the generation mix slipped to a 10-month low.

According to the latest Coal Ministry data, the share of renewable energy sources (RES) hit 19.94 per cent in India's cumulative power generation mix in July, which is an all-time monthly high.

This is against 19.02 per cent in June 2026 and 16.93 per cent in July 2025. RES includes solar, wind, biomass and others. While the share of coal-fired power generation slipped to 64.31 per cent last month, compared to 67.34 per cent in June and 63 per cent in July 2025.

HYDRO POWER UP 10%
The share of hydro power generation rose to 10.23 per

cent in July 2026 from 7.86 per cent in June 2026, but was lower than the 14.52 per cent share during July 2025.

The share of non-fossil fuel sources — RES, hydro and nuclear power — rose to 33.14 per cent last month from 30 per cent in June 2026 and 34.2 per cent in July 2025. The share of non-fossil fuel sources hit a 10-month high in July 2026.

According to Crisil Intelligence, power generation increased by around 10 per cent y-o-y to 182 BU during July 2026.

Except gas and hydro, all major fuels saw a year-on-year increase in power generation. Renewable energy (RE) generation increased around 10 per cent y-o-y in July, mainly due to a rise in capacity addition. India added 13.2 GW of RE capacity (including small hydro) in Q1 FY27, it added.

While coal-based generation increased 15 per cent y-o-y, its share in total genera-

tion was at 64 per cent this July, against 62 per cent in the same month last calendar year.

WEAK RAINFALL

Hydropower generation declined around 14 per cent y-o-y during the month, primarily because of weak rainfall.

The energy content of 31 reservoir-based hydropower projects stood at roughly 14 BU as of July 31, significantly lower than the full-reservoir capacity potential of about 34 BU, Crisil Intelligence pointed out.

In the same period last year, the energy content was around 22 BU. The lower reservoir storage level may also have contributed to the decline in hydropower generation.

For the April-July period, power demand increased around 9.1 per cent on-year this fiscal, against -0.5 per cent in the same period in the last financial year.

India, Canada aim to conclude trade talks by 2026-end

Press Trust of India
Washington

In a bid to deepen bilateral economic and financial co-operation, India and Canada have said they are looking to conclude negotiations on a Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement by the end of 2026 and initiate talks on a Bilateral Investment Treaty at the earliest.

At the inaugural Economic and Financial Dialogue in Toronto on Thursday, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman and Minister of Finance and National Revenue, François-Philippe Champagne of Canada agreed to support engagement between relevant authorities and stakeholders to explore opportunities relating to cross-border remittances and merchant payments.

They welcomed opportunities to broaden the use of UPI in Canada through partnerships with payment service providers, recognising that such efforts could con-



Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman

tribute to faster, and cost-effective payments and support bilateral trade, tourism, education, and the growth of small and medium-size enterprises in both countries, as per a joint statement issued after inaugural Economic and Financial Dialogue.

INVESTMENT TREATY

India also expressed its readiness to initiate negotiations on a Bilateral Investment Treaty at the earliest, the joint statement said.

The next India-Canada Economic and Financial Dialogue will be held in 2027.

India not inclined to make proposed US H-1B fee hike a bilateral issue, say sources

Amiti Sen
New Delhi

India is unlikely to turn the proposed steep increase in US H-1B visa fees into a bilateral issue, as the government views it primarily as a commercial matter for US employers seeking to hire foreign professionals rather than a matter requiring bilateral diplomatic intervention, sources said.

New Delhi also recognises that US visa policy and the conditions attached to the employment of foreign workers fall within Washington's sovereign domain, an argument the US has repeatedly made.

IMPACT ON IT FIRMS

While the proposed fee is likely to have a significant impact on Indian professionals and Indian IT companies based in the US, the government does not appear inclined to make it a bilateral issue with Washington.

"Visa policy and the conditions attached to employment of foreign workers fall within the sovereign domain of the US. The proposed increase in H-1B visa fees, although steep, will have to be borne by US-based entities if they want to hire foreign workers. It is a commercial



FEE SHOCK. Earlier this week, the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) proposed a \$103,265 additional fee on each H-1B cap-subject petition

decision and there is nothing that the Indian government could do about it," a source tracking the matter told *businessline*.

Earlier this week, the Department of Homeland Security (DHS) proposed a \$103,265 additional fee on each H-1B cap-subject petition, including those eligible for the US advanced-degree exemption.

The fee would be payable at the time of filing and would be in addition to all other applicable fees and payments.

The proposal follows a US federal judge's June decision striking down the Trump administration's \$100,000 H-1B fee, which was imposed through a presidential proclamation.

The new DHS measure

seeks to establish a \$103,265 charge through the rule-making process and would apply to all cap-subject H-1B petitions, including those eligible for the advanced-degree exemption.

The Indian government is not too keen this time to take up the matter of the visa fee hike with the US, on the ground that it is a sovereign issue, but in the past New Delhi has discussed visa related issues, including proposed fee hikes, with Washington.

In fact, in March 2016, India approached the WTO challenging the US and sought consultations over increased fees for certain H-1B and L-1 visa applicants, as well as a numerical restriction on H-1B visas. "India has been taking up the issue

of increased H-1B visas with Washington for a long time. That is because Indians are the highest users of these visas and any increase in visa fees affects the Indian IT industry. But ultimately it is a call the US takes on its own," another source said.

ANNUAL CAP

The H-1B programme has an annual cap of 65,000 visas, with an additional 20,000 places for foreign nationals who have earned a Master's or higher degree from a US institution of higher education.

Indian-born beneficiaries accounted for 71 per cent of all approved H-1B petitions in fiscal 2024, according to USCIS, with China accounting for about 12 per cent. Amazon, Tata Consultancy Services, Microsoft, Meta, Apple, Google, Deloitte, Infosys, Wipro and Tech Mahindra Americas were amongst the highest beneficiaries of H-1B visas issued in 2025, according to the USCIS.

IT industry body Nasscom, in a recent statement, noted that the proposed increase in visa fees should be viewed in the context of the programme's original purpose of enabling access to temporary skills where there is a shortage in the US.

Venezuela mulls OPEC exit as US discusses oil fields stake

Bloomberg

Venezuela is considering whether it should quit OPEC, according to people familiar with the matter, potentially delivering a fresh blow to the oil cartel it helped create more than six decades ago.

The idea of an exit has been a topic in conversations with US officials and no final decision has been made, said some of the people, asking not to be identified discussing private information.

A decision to pull out of the Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries (OPEC) would underline the sweeping political realignment in Caracas since US President Donald Trump ousted the long-time leader Nicolas Maduro and took control of the nation's oil sales. Washington's growing influence is also reflected in US talks with Venezuelan leaders to take a large stake in the nation's oil fields, a development that would have been unthinkable just two years ago.

Negotiators from both countries are discussing that proposal, according to people familiar with the matter who asked not to be identified because the discussions are private.

FCNR (B) inflows drive forex reserves to new high of \$729.32 b

Our Bureau
Mumbai

India's foreign exchange reserves soared to an all-time high of \$729.328 billion in the week ended August 21, 2026, with the reserves being boosted by robust inflows into foreign currency non-resident deposits mobilised by banks under the RBI's limited period concessional swap facility.

In the reporting week, the reserves jumped by \$12.422 billion. Since March-end 2026, India's reserves perked up by \$38.221 billion. The previous record high for India's forex reserves was \$728.494 billion in the week ended February 27, 2026.

With the RBI announcing an early end (August 31 against the original announcement of September 30) to the concessional swap facility, there has been a step up in inflows into the FCNR (B) deposits.

Between June 8, 2026, (when banks started mopping up resources under the RBI's concessional swap facility) till August 21, FCNR (B) deposits saw an accretion of a whopping \$65.397 billion, per the latest RBI data.

SWAP FACILITY

Under the RBI's concessional swap facility, banks



The previous record high for India's forex reserves was \$728.494 billion in the week ended February 27

and public sector undertakings raised \$4.86 billion (via overseas foreign currency borrowings) and \$2.591 billion (via external commercial borrowings), respectively.

Manoranjan Sharma, Chief Economist, Infomeries Ratings, observed that the sharp increase in forex reserves chiefly reflected an exceptional inflow episode, not merely an underlying trade-surplus improvement.

"The RBI's June measures to strengthen the balance of payments, especially incentives and facilities that attracted overseas foreign-currency inflows, including NRI/FCNR(B)-related deposits, brought substantial dollars into the banking system. The RBI absorbed part of these flows, including through discounted FX swaps, rather than allowing

an abrupt rupee appreciation," he said.

Sharma emphasised that the reserve accumulation materially strengthens India's external shock absorber, giving the RBI capacity to smooth disorderly rupee depreciation, finance essential imports during oil-price or geopolitical shocks, and reassure foreign investors about external-payment resilience.

"However, the quality and durability of the increase (in forex reserves) matter. Deposit-led inflows raise external liabilities and may reverse when incentives expire or global yields change. RBI dollar absorption also creates domestic liquidity-management costs.

"Thus, the record stock improves near-term stability, but should not mean that structural current-account vulnerabilities, especially oil dependence, have disappeared — no way!" he said.

DOLLAR INFLOWS

Amit Pabari, MD, CR Forex Advisors, underscored that the build up in forex reserves isn't accidental. RBI's measures (introduction of a special USD-INR forex swap facility covering FCNR(B) deposits, ECB and OFCB inflows on June 8) have pulled in \$72.848 billion till August 21 alone.

Trump administration seeks to restrict internships for international students

Reuters
Washington

President Donald Trump's administration has issued a memo for universities that seeks to restrict issuance of certain internship work authorisations for international students as the US federal government warned that colleges not complying with the regulations may lose certification to enroll foreign students.

The memo, dated August 24, said the Student and Exchange Visitor Program, which is part of the US Immigration and Customs Enforcement agency, has "observed a rise in Curricular Practical Training (CPT) authorisations that appear to violate regulatory needs which permit CPT only where the training is an integral part of an established curriculum."

"Failure to comply with SEVP regulations may result in an institution losing certification to enroll foreign students," the memo said.

It resulted in some schools, including the University of California, Los Angeles and the University of California, Berkeley, pausing certain applications for work



US President Donald Trump

authorisations for international students.

"UCLA has paused certain Curricular Practical Training authorisations while it reviews recent federal guidance and determines next steps," a UCLA spokesperson said.

TIGHTER CURBS

UC Berkeley's international office said the August 24 memo was "more narrow in focus, more direct, and includes content that is more restrictive in nature." The federal government had also issued an earlier memo in mid-August.

UC Berkeley's international office said it is unlikely that it will process certain work authorisation applications "in the near future" and urged those international students to plan accordingly.

It said it will continue processing "degree-requirement" CPT as normal and would resume processing "Doctoral Dissertation and Master's Thesis Research CPT." The office said it would consult legal experts to develop new processes aligning with new federal requirements.

"Nothing about these regulations has changed," the Department of Homeland Security, ICE's parent, said in a statement. "However, schools and employers should consider themselves on notice: under President Trump, abuse of this generous system will no longer be tolerated."

Separately, the US Justice Department alleged on Thursday admissions practices at the George Washington University School of Medicine and Health Services favoured Black and Hispanic applicants, citing findings of a probe as the Trump administration continued its diversity crackdown.

"We are disappointed by the DOJ's conclusions, which we believe are incorrect," the university said, saying the admissions policies were in compliance with law and not discriminatory.

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

With the successful completion of LIC and other OFS (offers for sale), the government managed to collect over 3/4th of the budget estimates under the Miscellaneous Capital Receipts (MCR) in the first five months of the fiscal year. Now, the expectation is that the overall collection will see a new high in FY27, provided the IDBI Bank strategic sale is completed.

The term MCR has replaced disinvestment proceeds and also been widened. Now, it includes proceeds from share sale (minority stake sale, strategic disinvestment or buy back) of Central public sector enterprises (CPSE) and mop-ups through asset monetisation. For fiscal year 2026-27, the government estimates to collect ₹80,000 crore under MCR.

KEY CONTRIBUTOR

As on date, the government has got over ₹62,000 crore, which includes over ₹55,700 crore through government

Miscellaneous Capital Receipts (Amount in ₹ crore)			
Name of CPSEs	% of Govt's shares disinvested	Receipts	Govt's shareholding post disinvestment
Central Bank of India	8.08	2,266.13	81.19
Coal India	2.00	5,542.36	61.13
NHPC	6.01	4,357.36	61.39
NLC India	2.73	1,223.57	69.47
General Insurance Corporation	5.00	3,090.47	77.40
Indian Railway Finance Corporation	1.75	2,081.27	82.90
Cochin Shipyard	4.58	1,711.24	63.33
Indian Medicines Pharmaceuticals Corpn	98.11	118.73	0.00
Others (Remittances from SUUTI)	0.00	810.00	0.00
Life Insurance Corporation	6.50	31,514.89	90.00
Hindustan Copper	6.00	3,041.27	60.14
Total		55,757.29	
Asset monetisation		6,366.93	
Grand Total		62,124.22	

Source: DIPAM

holding in various CPSEs and private companies (through SUUTI) and over ₹6,300 crore through asset monetisation. The biggest contribution came from LIC, where the government got over ₹35,000 crore by selling part of its stake through OFS through the stock exchanges.

OFS is a mechanism that allows promoters or major shareholders of a listed company to sell shares to the

public through the stock exchange platform. It requires less documentation and is much faster than an IPO or FPO (follow-on public offering).

Apart from LIC, data show the government completed OFS in Central Bank of India (over ₹2,200 crore), Coal India (over ₹5,500 crore), NHPC (over ₹4,300 crore), NLC (over ₹1,200 crore), GIC (over ₹3,000 crore),

Canada's Fairfax Financial Holdings' bid to acquire a 60.72 per cent stake in IDBI Bank from the government and the Life Insurance Corporation is likely to be approved soon. Going by the current price level, the deal could bring in over ₹56,000 crore, taking the total mop up under MCR much above the Budget estimates.

There are 68 CPSEs listed on the stock exchanges. The value of government shareholding in these companies is over ₹22.8 lakh crore.

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QUICKLY.

All-new Pulsar 125 and 150 mark 25 years of the brand



Bajaj has begun its 25-year celebration of the Pulsar by launching two all-new motorcycles, the Pulsar 125 and the Pulsar 150. Featuring new tech, along with a brand-new engine, gearbox, chassis and monoshock, and with bodywork that's a modernised take on yesteryear Pulsars, the new motorcycles are substantially different from their predecessors. The Pulsar 125 is priced ₹92,990, while prices for the Pulsar 150 range from ₹1.15 lakh to ₹1.23 lakh (all prices ex-showroom).

Honda Rebel 300 makes India debut at ₹2.22 lakh



The Rebel was among the most anticipated motorcycles in recent times and it's finally been launched in India at ₹2.22 lakh (standard variant). The Rebel 300 features a 286 cc single-cylinder liquid-cooled engine, a 6-speed gearbox and a power output of 29.5 bhp. There's an e-clutch variant, too, which allows for gearshifts without having to use the clutch lever, and it's priced ₹2.62 lakh (ex-showroom, Bengaluru).

BMW launches the X1 LWB in India with more comfort



The long-wheelbase version of the fourth-generation X1 has been launched at ₹49.9 lakh (ex-showroom), and it undercuts the existing X1 (short wheelbase) by a lakh. The X1 LWB scores high on backseat comfort and on its feature suite and is available exclusively with a 1.5-litre petrol engine, which produces 154.2 bhp. As a result of its pricing, the X1 LWB now serves as the entry point into the X1 range, which includes the short-wheelbase X1 and the electric iX1 LWB.

@TheMotorGram

The Prize of Cool

YELLOW FEVER. The Land Rover Defender Trophy Edition is anything but subtle. And yet, it might just be the most sensible of the lot

PRASHANT SHETTY

Ruman Devmane

For precisely two decades, between 1980 and 2000, there existed a competition you were happy to simply survive. The Camel Trophy wasn't exactly a race but rather a most intense test of man and machine over relentlessly gruelling terrain. What began in Brazil featuring three German teams armed with Jeeps quickly became Land Rover's domain and, in later years, extended as far as to Sumatra and even Siberia.

The Defender Trophy Edition is a hat-tip to that era of Land Rover's most iconic years as a focused off-road carmaker, long before it became the preferred chariot of the ridiculously affluent. Of course, the 'Camel' prefix couldn't be revived given strict tobacco advertising regulations; it was, in fact, the onset of this very framework that killed the Camel Trophy back in 2000 as well, other than Land Rover's own compulsions to pull the plug on it. That's in the past, though.

WIN WIN
Today, Land Rover has every reason to celebrate, given just how tremendous a success the Defender has been globally. And while there may be fewer takers for a competition as intense as the Camel Trophy, those in the know never stopped longing for the revival of that iconic livery. The Trophy Edition is, for now, exclusively reserved for the Defender 110 variant — the 90 really deserves it, too, I think — and you can only have one with a rather brilliant diesel engine. Other Defenders can be had with either a 2.0-litre four-cylinder or a 5.0-litre V8 (both petrol), but the Trophy's 3.0-litre inline-six diesel, also available on other versions, is perhaps the most compelling one. More on that later.
For Trophy money, what you get

is essentially a very evocative paint scheme and some really cool equipment. It's not as if a Defender of any sort fails to turn heads in India, which speaks volumes for its design appeal, given that it's essentially a six-year-old car that was only face-lifted sometime ago, but the Trophy is an immediate attention magnet. The expanse of yellow offset with black trim, its purposeful 20-inch steel rims, a host of add-ons in the form of the external 'panniers', a side step and a seemingly over-engineered roof rack all come together to give the Trophy unbeatable road presence. This one should have been called the 'Attacker', perhaps!

PLUSH POINT
On the inside, you'll find no changes to the layout, which is a good thing because the Defender's is as practical a cabin as you'll ever find in a luxury off-roader. There's a multitude of physical buttons on the steering wheel and dash, the infotainment screen is large and slick (and still doesn't dominate your view), and the only new bit is the use of yellow surfaces in the dashboard inset and across the door trim. This last bit had every reason to appear childish, but with the right use of quality materials it just looks so cool!
A few more 'tactical' bits may have spruced up the cabin to go with the Trophy theme, but what those might've been I can't say. A cleverly concealed dagger or an AI-powered mine-extractor, maybe?
On comfort, the Trophy scores really high. The seats are fantastic (I did two 500-km driving days in it and would have happily done a third), the ergonomics and outward visibility are fantastic, and the ride quality is really impressive for a car that doesn't need to behave. Sure, it shows its bulk in corners by producing noticeable body roll, but knowing what it can accomplish over awful terrain, its composure is truly



READY TO RAID. The Trophy's cabin features premium but hardy materials. External 'panniers' are great to store off-road-soiled items but slightly impede rear view. The steel wheels look cool! PRASHANT SHETTY

admirable. This is not a small or light vehicle by any means, okay?
Over small speed bumps or potholes, you'll barely hear a thing in the cabin and, while this goes without saying, even over the roughest roads, the Trophy simply goes about its business nonchalantly. Air suspension is a paid extra, using which you can raise its ride height even further and in an instant, although I wish it were offered as standard on a car meant to serve as a tribute to among the most hardcore chapters of Land Rover's legacy. I really liked driving it with the suspension raised to its

highest — that feeling was just irresistible — although the ride height drops to its normal setting the moment you exceed 80 kph, which is sensible.
Party tricks aside, the Trophy still is a thoroughly enjoyable car to drive. That six-cylinder diesel engine is a treat in every way, naturally for the incredible amount of torque (71.3 kg-m) it delivers but also for being surprisingly efficient if you can get yourself to drive it gently. On a tankful of diesel, it can comfortably get you past 600 km and, on instances, it even relayed an average fuel consumption of as much as

11 kpl on its MID. Realistically, you can expect it to deliver 8-9 kpl in a mixed driving cycle.

GOING FOR GOLD
What impresses most about the diesel is its tractability and power delivery. This is a punchy engine that produces 345.2 bhp, and it can propel the Trophy to 100 kph from standstill in under 7 seconds.
The performance it delivers under aggressive driving is far from sedate; if you thought drama was solely the domain of the V8-engined Octa, you couldn't be further from the truth. It's also an extremely refined engine which, paired with the smooth 8-speed gearbox, makes for a well-rounded driving experience.
On a liveability index, this engine would score the highest among all the others you can have in a Defender. Obviously, the Trophy must be phenomenal off-road, right? Must be. I simply wasn't feeling brave enough to try. Never mind the friendly forewarning from Land Rover to 'keep off-roading light,' I simply don't see why anyone would want to drive a ₹1.3 crore (ex-showroom) car off the road, curiosity aside. Sure, it might look great on Instagram, but for once I think it's a good thing I have so few followers.
Never mind the tiny inconvenience in the form of the dash cam our test car came equipped with. Have fun watching a 1,200 km road trip in 4k resolution, Land Rover.
What the Trophy is, is a really special car to travel and make memories with. It's fun and iconic, even if constrained by compliances, and its charm extends far beyond its capabilities. If buying a Defender and not being discreet about it was on your agenda this weekend, the Trophy Edition deserves a hike to your friendly neighbourhood Land Rover dealership. And count me in for a day of proper mud-plugging too!

@TheMotorGram

The E-ternal flame



MODERN ARISTOCRACY. The Mercedes-Benz E220d does understated elegance like nothing else, as we drive it to find out if the E-Class nameplate can still hold its own

PREMIUM APPEAL. The spacious cabin feels opulent and tastefully designed, while high screen dependence can feel laborious, though the ample boot space, featuring a space-saver spare wheel, adds practicality YASH GAWDE

Ruman Devmane

In recent years, the Mercedes-Benz E-Class has moved away from making headlines. It's not the kind of car that feels the need to grab attention and that's exactly the kind of buyer it attracts as well. The E-Class is a no-nonsense formula for when you've decided that life is about

much more than being the talk of the town. In a way, the E-Class isn't a car you buy, it's what you become. Cruising at the expressway speed limit on a rainy morning, I was surprised at how quiet the E220d's cabin felt. The tachometer needle was barely above its resting spot and there was no indication that the car I happened to be piloting down the highway was diesel-powered. While its 2.0-litre four-cylinder engine pro-

duces a respectable 194.4 bhp, it feels more at home being driven in a stately manner rather than spiritedly. So, rather than digging for an outwardly sporty flavour, I instead derived great satisfaction from the DTE indicator, which stated I had 1,094 km to go before needing a refuel. The only thing amiss was a chauffeur, which denied me the chance to sprawl out in the backseat before the eventual-ity of a deep slumber would arrive.

PRACTICAL CAR
It's been around for a while, of course, but having only recently gotten my hands on it, I was quite keen to spend time with a car that boasts among the world's most revered nameplates. The E-Class rests on a long-standing reputation of being a dependable luxury sedan and this E220d, with its manners and subtle opulence, was making a point rather effortlessly. This still is — yes, despite all of the

world's attempts at reinventing the wheel — a perfectly practical car with a seemingly natural ability to deliver premiumness.
In the front row, your view is most certainly dominated by the three screens, which also feature many of the important controls. I wish it weren't that way because it just gets in the way of the otherwise sublime and intuitive driving experience the E220d has to offer. Outward visibility is just fant-

astic, courtesy the large glass areas and the front-row seating is beautifully configured for long driving days.
The seats offer great support and adjustability, although the exclusion of ventilation is a sore miss. The backseat is, undoubtedly, the star of the show with its reclining backrest and tremendous legroom. However, set against an SUV-dominated world, ingress and egress can feel



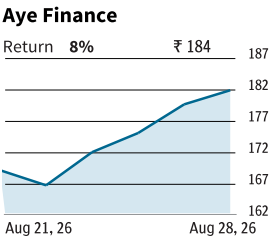
a bit challenging given its inherently low stance (as a sedan, that is). The seat base is well-designed, offering great under-thigh support and the centre armrest feels substantial and well-appointed. There's also an excellent ambient lighting suite, which is a sight to behold at night!

COMFORT CLASS
On less-than-ideal roads, the E220d is remarkably composed and while you can feel the relative (to an SUV — sigh!) lack of suspension travel, it still offers a fairly plush ride. On a great road, the E220d will convince you it's all the car you'll ever need. While it may be a step (or two) lower than the S-Class, mechanically speaking, it has inherited the same character of wafting in a great manner that makes it immensely endearing. Watch out for ill-designed speed breakers, though! On the whole, it's a really easy car to drive, in the city or otherwise. I, for one, admire the respectful distance the E220d maintains from aggression; that may be fun in short bursts, but over a long day of business travel, and an even longer tenure of ownership, comfort is what will mean much more to you.
A couple of years ago, I grudged it the lack of screens for the rear row, but given how much I don't want to look at a screen any more, it now feels like a very good thing. With its ₹83.5 lakh (ex-showroom) price tag, the E-Class faces competition from all quarters, including its own siblings, but buying one is still among the wisest calls you'll ever make.

@TheMotorGram

QUICKLY.

Alpha Wave Global exits Aye Finance via block deal



New Delhi: Alpha Wave Global has exited from Aye Finance, by divesting its entire 7.78 per cent stake in the micro-enterprise lender for ₹322 crore through a series of block deals on the BSE. Alpha Wave India LP, an affiliate of the New York-based alternative asset manager, sold more than 1.91 crore shares in two tranches, at prices ranging from ₹168.02 to ₹168.19 apiece, according to data on the BSE. A mix of domestic and foreign institutional investors, including US-based Millenium Management and veteran investor Madhusudan Kela's Singularity AMC bought shares at the same price. **PTI**

Annu Projects public issue subscribed nearly 3x

Bengaluru: Annu Projects IPO was subscribed 2.93 times on Friday, led by demand from non-institutional investors. The NII portion was subscribed 3.55 times, followed by the retail portion at 2.68 times and the QIB quota at 1.72 times. The company had a fixed a price range of ₹94-99 a share for its ₹175-crore initial public offering. It comprised a fresh issue of 1,76,83,000 shares. The company plans to utilise ₹115 crore of the IPO proceeds for funding working capital requirements. Another ₹15 crore will be used for capital expenditure requirements for the purchase of machinery or equipment, while the remainder will be utilised for general corporate purposes. **OUR BUREAU**

BROKER'S CALL.

JM Financial

TATA POWER (BUY)
Target: ₹422
CMP: ₹351.65
Tata Power's longstanding dispute with Kleros Capital is back in focus after a Singapore court rejected the former's challenge to arbitral awards issued last year. Kleros Capital and Tata Power had signed an NDA in 2013 to explore coal mining in Russia to source lower-cost coal for its Mundra plant. The partnership later broke down, after which Tata Power obtained the mining licence independently through a Russian subsidiary in 2018. Kleros alleged that Tata Power breached its confidentiality obligations and commenced arbitration proceedings in Nov'20. Meanwhile, the coal exploration project of Tata Power also did not advance. The tribunal held Tata Power liable for breaching NDA and directed it to pay \$490 million in damages with interest. Tata Power appealed to Singapore International Commercial Court (SICC) to set aside the SIAC arbitral award, but the appeal was rejected. Tata Power has 28 days to appeal to Singapore Court of Appeal (SCA). We estimate a provision of ₹6,000 crore (\$650 million), representing 4-5 per cent of our target valuation. We maintain Buy with a target price of ₹422 (earlier ₹444), factoring in FY26 actuals.

Choice Broking

VARUN BEVERAGES (BUY)
Target: ₹550
CMP: ₹414
Varun Beverages Ltd's (VBL) growth rests on two levers. In India, the opportunity is penetration led where VBL reaches only about four million of an estimated 12 million FMCG outlets and per capita consumption (7 litres) remains a fraction of the global level (31 litres), leaving a multi year runway even as Reliance's Campa and Coca-Cola compete intensely. In international markets, increasingly Africa centric, VBL has methodically built scale through a mix of greenfield entry (DRC, Kenya) and bolt-on M&A (BevCo, Twizza, Crickley Dairy in South Africa), lifting International's share of revenue from 20 per cent in CY21 to 33 per cent in CY25 and expects 40 per cent by CY28. We initiate coverage with a 'Buy' rating and a target price of ₹550, valuing the stock at 40x Sep-28E EPS. Upside triggers: Faster international scale-up and margin convergence, alongside continued India volume growth and visi-cooler penetration; and premiumisation and portfolio diversification through energy drink, dairy, snacks and new adjacencies such as Calpis, Carlsberg and proposed entry into RTD alcoholic beverages. **Key Risks:** Rising competitive intensity and adverse weather conditions; slower than expected international margin convergence toward India levels; slower than expected scaling of new categories and adjacencies, including dairy, snacks, Calpis and AlcoBev; and Regulatory risk pertaining over product categorisation, formulation standards, and misleading labelling.

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IT stocks aid Nifty recovery, focus on Federal Reserve Chair's cues

RENEWED INTEREST. TCS, Tech Mahindra and Infosys score handsome gains, following Nvidia strong results

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

The benchmarks ended the week on a positive note on Friday, snapping a two-session losing streak, as a global technology rally, sparked by Nvidia's blowout quarterly results and upbeat revenue outlook, sent domestic IT stocks surging, masking an otherwise cautious and range-bound session.

"IT is emerging as the top outperformer, tracking global technology gains after Nvidia's strong quarterly results and upbeat revenue outlook," said Ajit Mishra, SVP Research, Religare Broking.

With the prevailing geo-political uncertainty, the fo-

cus now shifts to Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh's remarks at the Jackson Hole symposium, he said.

The Nifty 50 closed at 24,175, 0.35 per cent, while the Sensex settled at 77,264, gaining 0.43 per cent.

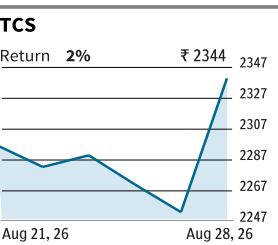
The Nifty IT index led sectoral gains, surging 3.5 per cent on Friday, with TCS, Tech Mahindra and Infosys among the top Nifty 50 gainers. Metals and pharma also ended in the green.

FMCG, auto and energy faced selling pressure and closed in the red.

The Bank Nifty ended nearly flat, slipping 0.02 per cent to 57,496.

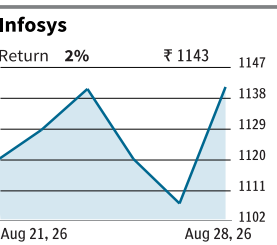
SECTOR-SPECIFIC

The session's advance was largely sector-specific. The



broader markets tracked the benchmark modestly, with the Nifty Midcap 100 edging up 0.05 per cent and the Nifty Smallcap 100 gaining 0.2 per cent, the latter continuing to trade near all-time highs.

The advance-decline ratio improved to 1.25, though within the Nifty 500 universe, 286 stocks ended in the red against 207 in the green. NSE cash turnover



slipped 4 per cent from the previous session. For the week, the Nifty fell 0.3 per cent, marking its third straight weekly decline.

Sentiment also drew support from a pause in the West Asia tensions and a rebound in FII inflows during the month.

Ankur Punj, Managing Director, Equirus Wealth, noted that investors had been "steadily increasing ex-

Bharat PET, 3 others get SEBI nod to float IPOs

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

As many as four companies — Bharat PET Ltd, Sadbhav Futuretech, Paras Healthcare and MK Sons Fine Jewels — have received SEBI's clearance to float initial public offerings (IPOs).

The SEBI clearance is a key step in the process, after which companies can proceed with further preparations for their public issues.

All four companies filed their draft IPO papers between March and June. They obtained SEBI's final observations during August 24-28, an update with the regulator showed.

Tempsens clocks biggest listing gain of 110% in 2026, closes at ₹586.65 vs IPO price of ₹300

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Tempsens Instruments (India) shares jumped over 110 per cent to ₹631.2 on the BSE and ₹634 on the NSE on their market debut against the IPO price of ₹300, marking the biggest listing gain on the exchanges this year.

After Sigachi Industries' 250 per cent gains in 2021, this is the second highest on the mainboard.

The stock, however, settled a tad weak at ₹586.80 and ₹586.65 on the BSE and the NSE, a gain of nearly 96 per cent over the IPO price. Swastika Investmart's



A PERFECT TON. (from left) Priyanka Menaria, CFO, Vinay Rathi, MD, and Aryan Rathi, Lead, Global Sales of Tempsens Instruments (India), at the listing ceremony

Shivani Nyati said Tempsens Instruments' strong debut reflects its category leadership, financial growth, healthy margins and favourable industrial indigenisation themes. However, she

SEBI issues observations on NSE's IPO draft papers

Akshata Gorde
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has issued observations on the draft papers filed by the National Stock Exchange (NSE) for its long-awaited initial public offering.

The regulator has issued observations to the NSE on August 21 and is awaiting a response from the exchanges' lead manager.

The update comes a day after SEBI Chairman Tuhin Kanta Pandey said the market regulator was "close" to approving the NSE's draft papers.

The NSE had filed its draft red herring prospectus with SEBI in June for an offer for sale of up to 148.9 million shares with a face value of ₹1 each, representing nearly 6 per cent of its paid-up capital.

The NSE's listing plans have been in the works for

years and had faced regulatory hurdles for the last decade, including issues related to the co-location and dark fibre cases. The exchange's IPO plans gained momentum after SEBI gave it a no-objection certificate earlier this year. Last month, the regulator in-principle agreed to settle the applications filed by the NSE in the co-location and dark fibre matters for ₹1,491.21 crore.

The stock is currently trading at a valuation of around ₹5 lakh crore in the unlisted market and is expected to be one of the largest IPOs by size, at around ₹30,000 crore.

The exchange has appointed 20 book-running lead managers, including Kotak Mahindra Capital, which is the coordinating lead manager.

Once SEBI completes its review and clears the draft papers, NSE can proceed with the next steps towards launching the IPO.

capital remain key risks.

IPO DETAILS

The ₹650-crore IPO of the thermal engineering and specialised cable manufacturer was subscribed 184.07 times, as all category investors poured in money.

Ahead of the IPO, Tempsens Instruments raised ₹194.55 crore from anchor investors. The IPO comprised a fresh issue of ₹95 crore and an OFS of ₹555 crore. The Udaipur-based company plans to use the proceeds for capital expenditure in electrical heating and specialised cable solutions, debt repayment and general corporate purposes.

Waves of old economy, niche players buoy IPO market

RINGSIDE VIEW.

KS BADRI NARAYANAN

The Indian primary market has been buzzing in recent years, emerging as one of the most active IPO markets globally, with the number of issues crossing 350 annually. Both the mainboard and SME segments have attracted a growing pool of companies and investors.

Traditionally, IPO activity tends to peak when the secondary market is thriving and benchmark indices are scaling new highs. But this cycle has been different. Even as the Nifty and the Sensex have largely moved sideways, there has been little let-up in primary-market activity. The SME segment, in particular, has witnessed a relentless run, underscoring a growing appetite for smaller, niche businesses.

INDUSTRIAL PLAYERS

Old-economy sectors — traditional industries with roots in the Industrial Revolution, centred on physical goods, heavy manufacturing and

manual labour — are making a strong return to the capital markets. In earlier years, IPOs tended to chase whichever theme was in vogue at the time — IT, telecom, infrastructure or financial services. This cycle is different: companies spanning steel and coal, textiles, power, recycling and metals are all increasingly finding their way to the market.

For instance, several old-economy players have tapped the market, including Lumino Industries, Annu Projects and Laser Power & Infra (EPC); Kusumgar and Aastha Spintex (textiles); Ardee Industries (metal recycling); Indo-MIM and Hy-Tech Engineers (high-precision engineered components and assemblies); GSP Crop Science (agrochemicals); Behari Lal Engineering (iron and steel); Shiprocket, Horizon Industries and LEAP India (logistics); MV Electrosystems (electrical and power electronics equipment); and Augmont Enterprises (an integrated gold and silver platform).

FIRST-OF-A KIND

At the other end of the spectrum, several niche players



BACK WITH A BANG. Both the mainboard and SME platforms of the stock exchanges have attracted several IPOs from companies in the old-economy sector **GETTY IMAGES**

have also entered the market recently. These include Tempsens Instruments (a thermal engineering and specialised cable manufacturing company); Gaja Alternative (the first alternative investment fund company to tap the market); Rays of Belief (a for-profit social enterprise that delivers personalised therapy and early-intervention programmes for children with neurodevelopmental disorders, including autism); and Kwick Forensic Solutions Ltd (a forensic science and digital solutions firm on the SME platform).

While Sify Infinit Spaces Ltd, the first pure-play data

centre company, deferred its public issue plans, the IPO of ESDS Software Solution, a cloud, data centre and AI ecosystem provider, is currently under way.

It is also heartening to see high-profile, institution-backed companies such as Sedemac Mechatronics (IIT Bombay), Indo-MIM Ltd (IIT Madras) and Ather Energy (IIT Madras) tap the capital markets. Companies from Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Bihar, have also launched IPOs on the mainboard of the exchanges.

INDIA LEADS

The divergence signals a

shift. India's IPO market is no longer merely riding broader market momentum. It is being powered by a wider and more diverse set of companies tapping public capital.

The message from subscription levels is unambiguous — with most IPOs heavily oversubscribed, demand for primary-market offerings remains strong and sustained.

However, a SEBI study in 2024 found that about 54 per cent of IPO shares (in value terms) allotted to investors, excluding anchor investors, were sold within a week of listing.

Individual investors sold 50.2 per cent of their allotted shares within a week of listing. Investors come to IPOs with different aims. Some are drawn by the prospect of short-term listing gains; others are in it for the long haul. The approach ultimately depends on an individual's financial goals and risk appetite.

One thing is clear: India's primary market is rapidly emerging as a global growth engine, drawing companies, investors and capital from across sectors and geographies. One hopes the trend will continue.

Trafiksol, promoters barred from market for a year

Our Bureau
Mumbai

SEBI has barred Trafiksol ITS Technologies and its promoters, Jitendra Narayan Das and Poonam Das, from the securities market for one year and imposed monetary penalties after finding misleading disclosures and other lapses in the company's aborted ₹44.87-crore initial public offering (IPO).

The regulator imposed penalties of ₹30 lakh on Trafiksol, ₹50 lakh on Jitendra Das and ₹25 lakh on Poonam Das. The final order follows SEBI's investigation into Trafiksol's September 2024 SME IPO, whose listing was deferred after complaints over the proposed use of issue proceeds.

SEBI's investigation covered alleged misleading financial disclosures, concealment of material facts and false information relating to Oasis Corpcare, from which the company obtained a quotation for software worth ₹17.7 crore.

SEBI had earlier cancelled the issue and directed the company to refund investors. "The present case did not result in any loss to the IPO subscribers. Due to regulatory intervention, the issue was ultimately cancelled and the subscription monies were refunded with interest," SEBI Whole-time member Amarjeet Singh said in the final order.

The Securities Appellate Tribunal had also dismissed Trafiksol's appeal against the earlier SEBI order.

SEBI suggests easing merchant banker rule for small-value debt issues

Our Bureau
Mumbai

The Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) has proposed granting an exemption from mandatory appointment of a merchant banker for small-value debt issued by listed companies through a private placement in order to reduce compliance costs and boost market development.

The current rule requires issuers to appoint at least one merchant banker for private placements of debt securities or non-convertible redeemable preference shares with a face value of ₹10,000.

The mandatory appointment of merchant bankers increases costs, causes delays



and hurts price-sensitive debt issuances where market yields can move quickly. Further, the limited number of merchant bankers active in the debt segment is also a hindrance, SEBI said, inviting public comments by September 17.

STRICT CRITERIA

The exemption is restricted to issuers meeting four con-

ditions, such as being registered with or regulated by a financial sector regulator, including SEBI, RBI, the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India or the PFRDA.

The issuer must also have been listed on a recognised stock exchange for at least one year and have no pending fines or penalties from SEBI or the stock exchanges for applicable listing-related non-compliance.

Additionally, the issuer must not have defaulted in the last three financial years and the current financial year regarding the repayment of deposits or interest payable on them. The issuer must also submit an auditor's certificate confirming this to the stock exchange.

Nifty 50 Movers					▲ 84.80 pts.
	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)	
HDFC Bank	720.30	31.12	13.44	9.97	
Infosys	1144.00	25.45	15.31	3.63	
TCS	2342.00	20.88	16.93	2.16	
HCL Tech	1236.10	7.26	20.49	1.25	
Tech Mahindra	1640.90	7.76	31.15	0.94	
Reliance Ind	1287.00	7.09	19.75	7.86	
Axis Bank	1265.00	5.65	14.08	3.28	
L&T	4045.80	4.81	28.36	4.28	
Bajaj Auto	11910.00	4.60	28.81	1.19	
Hindalco	1037.40	4.24	14.22	1.36	
State Bank	1047.50	4.15	10.78	3.91	
Bharti Airtel	1882.40	2.72	31.50	5.17	
Titan	5169.20	2.70	79.67	1.93	
Wipro	180.95	2.69	13.49	0.44	
Grasim Ind	3290.00	2.64	19.68	1.12	
Sun Pharma	1920.00	1.55	38.02	1.84	
Tata Motors PV	319.40	1.55	0.00	0.60	
Trent Ltd.	2898.00	1.42	85.16	0.87	
PowerGrid Corp	266.05	1.14	15.57	1.09	
Apollo Hosp	8838.50	0.87	58.51	0.82	
Max Healthcare	1014.10	0.83	67.72	0.68	
M&M	3344.00	0.78	20.48	2.69	
Nestle India	1454.60	0.73	73.60	0.94	
Bharat Elec	411.90	0.70	48.98	1.33	
Coal India	401.00	0.52	7.92	0.87	
Cipla	1423.50	0.43	34.27	0.72	
Hind Unilever	2010.40	0.27	45.01	1.61	
Jio Financial Services Ltd.	238.40	0.22	76.18	0.71	
ONGC	323.25	0.21	6.52	0.82	
Dr Reddy's Lab	1178.00	0.13	30.89	0.65	
HDFC Life	548.00	0.00	59.87	0.53	
Adani Enter	3168.50	-0.03	54.87	0.83	
TataConsumerProduct	1040.70	-1.18	62.71	0.61	
JSW Steel	1334.90	-0.53	11.66	1.13	
Tata Steel	186.50	-0.54	20.67	1.39	
Eternal Ltd.	238.00	-0.73	38.32	1.04	
Kotak Bank	423.70	-0.80	20.76	2.82	
NTPC	330.05	-0.88	11.30	1.41	
Adani Ports	1707.50	-1.05	29.98	1.14	
Bajaj Finserv	2002.00	-1.14	15.53	1.05	
Int'lGlobeAve	5166.00	-1.14	0.00	1.06	
SBI Life	1761.10	-1.54	67.93	0.72	
Eicher Motors	8059.00	-1.23	38.12	1.00	
Bajaj Finance	1079.90	-1.82	32.56	2.62	
Maruti Suzuki	13376.00	-1.82	29.34	1.58	
Asian Paints	2608.70	-2.20	51.73	1.07	
UltraTech Cement	11589.00	-3.31	39.84	1.24	
Shriram Finance Ltd.	106.90	-4.32	22.59	1.38	
ITC	266.00	-6.32	16.51	2.32	
ICICI Bank	1422.80	-31.62	17.08	9.21	

Pts: Impact on index movement

Nifty Next 50 Movers

▼ 188.30 pts.

	Close(₹)	Pts	PE	WN(%)
Divis Lab	9239.00	66.11	83.85	4.60
Ltimindtree	4675.00	56.95	26.68	1.70
Vedanta	287.95	34.25	6.74	1.91
Macrochem Developers	1274.00	22.33	30.83	1.38
Torrent Pharma	5050.00	21.74	89.09	2.90
Hindus Zinc	622.00	16.63	15.40	1.17
Jindal Steel	1179.20	9.90	44.41	1.71
Union Bank	186.00	8.42	6.88	1.41
Bpcl	319.25	7.36	8.08	2.54
DII	679.80	6.80	37.85	1.71
Hyundai Motor India	2267.00	5.80	37.21	1.27
Bank Of Baroda	241.90	4.85	6.80	1.76
Britannia Ind	5308.50	3.59	48.99	2.45
Abb India	7509.00	2.90	102.32	1.54
Canara Bank	128.35	2.05	5.87	1.69
MuthootFin	3091.00	1.87	10.83	1.30
Ambuja Cements	412.05	1.81	19.74	1.01
ZydusIntelligence	1191.00	1.31	26.09	1.17
Cummins India	5193.00	1.18	60.81	2.75
Punjab Natl Bank	115.40	0.00	5.99	1.56
Tata Capital	375.70	-0.44	29.11	0.74
Tata Power	351.85	-0.73	21.39	2.30
Siemens	4089.00	-1.54	100.23	1.92
Bosch	4864.00	-3.53	60.70	1.65
Siemens Energy India	3242.60	-3.55	77.60	1.12
Hdfc Amc	2569.00	-3.55	37.36	2.05
Indian Railway Finance Corp	83.90	-4.38	15.25	0.66
Axis Bank	121.00	-5.10	15.40	2.01
SavzarandMethosonInternat	165.60	-5.14	38.37	3.87
MagmaDof Bank	2555.00	-7.29	36.11	0.76
Bajaj Holdings	11340.00	-7.42	14.03	1.92
AvenueSuper	3839.60	-7.87	81.72	2.42
Godrej Consumer	915.00	-9.34	48.93	1.44
United Spirits	1510.00	-10.30	18.74	1.00
Gil India	171.10	-10.50	11.40	1.81
Solar Industries	20400.00	-12.74	90.03	1.95
Rural Elec	316.80	-14.88	5.20	1.55
CholamandalamIn&Fin	1862.90	-15.72	27.61	1.36
Power Finance	35.20	-16.29	3.45	2.01
Adani Energy	121.00	-17.05	10.00	1.72
Cg Power & Ind Sol	889.00	-17.73	113.09	2.39
Shree Cement	2440.00	-18.66	52.93	1.26
Vinvar Beverages	414.00	-18.87	41.07	2.22
HindustanAeronautics	4861.10	-20.89	34.88	3.61
Pidilite	225.00	-23.86	6.64	1.98
Adani Power	212.63	-28.58	28.22	4.46
Indian Hotels Co	706.40	-30.88	43.55	2.43
Adani Energy Solutions	1581.40	-33.98	61.47	2.04
Tata Motors Cv	466.30	-41.27	41.01	3.82
Tvs Motor Corp	4304.20	-72.09	56.78	3.96

Pts: Impact on index movement

QUICKLY.

Alpha Wave Global sells 1.7% stake in Lenskart



New Delhi: Global alternative asset firm Alpha Wave Global divested a 1.7 per cent stake in eyewear retailer Lenskart Solutions for ₹1,856 crore through open market transactions. New York-based Alpha Wave Global, through its three affiliates, offloaded a total of 2,94,72,670 shares, representing a 1.69 per cent stake in Lenskart. The shares were sold at an average price of ₹630 apiece, taking the combined transaction value to ₹1,856.78 crore. At the end of the June quarter, Alpha Wave Global, through its affiliates, owned a combined 4.64 per cent equity stake in Lenskart. On the other side of the trade were a mix of domestic and foreign institutional investors who picked up shares at the same price. **PM**

Govt eases defence export rules to boost reach of indigenous weapons

TAKING THE LEAD. Stakeholder consultation dispensed with for the export of non-lethal defence items

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Unlocking policy barriers hindering the global reach of indigenous weapon systems, the Ministry of Defence (MoD) has simplified its defence export standard operating procedure (SOP) and open general export licence (OGEL) framework to ease compliance burdens and accelerate access to global markets.

RECORD PRODUCTION
These reforms are expected to further strengthen the momentum of India's defence manufacturing and export ecosystem, with defence production reaching an all-time high of ₹1.78 lakh crore and defence exports touching record ₹38,424 crore in FY26. India exports weapons

systems and platforms such as BrahMos supersonic cruise missiles, Akash-1S surface-to-air missile, Pinaka multi-barrel rocket launchers, ATAGS 155mm howitzers and artillery shells, patrol vessels, light-weight torpedoes and armoured vehicles to around 100 countries, including to the US, France, Israel, Armenia, Philippines and Italy. Under the new defence export standard operating procedure, stakeholder consultation has been dispensed with for the export of non-lethal defence items to most destinations, while appropriate safeguards have been retained for sensitive countries, said the Minister in a statement on Friday. Ahead of the announcement, Sanjeev Kumar, Secretary, Department of Defence Production, had said at an Assocham event on Tues-



MAKING PROGRESS. At present, India exports weapons systems and platforms to around 100 countries

day that the export licensing regime is being rationalised, with him delegating powers to a Joint Secretary in his department, and a one-time, multi-year export authorisation regime under consideration for long-term supply partners of global OEMs. The revised open general

Ministry's statement read. It provides greater flexibility while reducing repetitive procedural requirements.

UNIFIED OGEL SOP
The MoD also stated that three existing OGEL SOPs covering major platforms and equipment, parts and components and intra-company transfer of technology, have been merged into one unified OGEL SOP, providing exporters with a common and simpler framework. The OGEL validity has been increased from two to three years, reducing the frequency of renewals and associated compliance requirements. Moreover, the OGEL coverage has been expanded from 41 to all countries, "except negative/sensitive nations and those facing UN Security Council sanctions or arms embargoes".

New technologies like AI will create more jobs: Radhakrishnan

Our Bureau
New Delhi

Vice-President CP Radhakrishnan said on Friday that new technologies such as artificial intelligence (AI) will enhance ease of doing work and help create more jobs.

'NOT A THREAT'
Speaking at the launch of Gnani Artha, an end-to-end sovereign AI stack for Indian enterprises and public institutions, he said concerns over job losses were raised when computers were introduced in the country, but the IT industry had turned out to

be the biggest job creator not only within the country but even overseas. He said even highly qualified people were raising concerns about a reduction in jobs due to the induction of AI in their fields. "The more technology comes in, the more ease of work will come. That will create more jobs. Bharat has undergone significant transformation in almost every sector, including in AI, in the past 12 years," said Radhakrishnan. He also noted that reverse migration has started taking place now, and people are coming back to the country, bringing new technologies



(from left) Ganesh Gopalan, CEO & Co-founder, Gnani.ai; Vice-President of India CP Radhakrishnan; and Ananth Nagaraj, Co-founder & CTO, Gnani.ai, at the launch of Gnani Artha

that they learnt over the years. For instance, Digital Sansad had started using AI to translate parliamentary debates and papers available

in multiple Indian languages, he said, adding that AI had tremendous scope. Talking about Gnani Artha, he said it is a part of a

larger national journey towards self-reliance. "May this initiative contribute to building a stronger, more self-reliant and technologically empowered India. That is my wish," he added.

GNANI EVON V3.3
Developed by Gnani.ai, Gnani Artha is backed by the government's India AI Mission to develop sovereign AI technology. Radhakrishnan unveiled Gnani Evon v3.3, a 30-billion-parameter open-weights model trained natively across 11 Indian languages — and Gnani Plexus, the company's agentic AI platform. "We are offering Indic lan-

guage capability at the lowest possible cost. The terminology that we used was Indic language capability on a cost-per-compute basis. That is where we score much better than any other model in the market. Our models consume 40 per cent less tokens; indirectly it's a 40 per cent cost-saving for these companies," said Ganesh Gopalan, Co-founder and CEO, Gnani.ai. The reasoning model Gnani Evon v3.3 is an open source model, which already started seeing traction from enterprise clients in banking, finance and insurance sectors, as well as retail segment players, Gopalan added.

Fino Payments Bank 'on track to meet RBI conditions to convert to small finance bank'

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Fino Payments Bank Ltd (FPBL) is advancing well and remains on track to meet the RBI-stipulated conditions for transition to a small finance bank (SFB), according to Interim CEO Ketan Merchant.

"We continue to expect that all required milestones will be completed within the prescribed 18-month timeline, and we remain on course to submit our readiness to the Reserve Bank of India by the end of Q4 FY27," he said. The RBI, on December 5, 2025, granted in-principle approval to FPBL for conversion to an SFB. According to RBI guidelines for on-tap licensing of SFBs in the private sector, existing payments banks, which are con-



Ketan Merchant, Interim CEO, Fino Payments Bank

trolled by residents and have completed five years of operations, are eligible for conversion to SFBs. "We have appointed Price-waterhouseCoopers to support the implementation and overall operational readiness of SFB. We have also on-boarded technology partners for our loan origination system, loan management system and other lending applications that will form the

backbone of our lending platform," said Merchant in a recent analyst call. Alongside this, the bank continues to strengthen its governance framework by putting in place the required policies, operating procedures and compliance process to support SFB.

TECHNOLOGY STACK
In parallel, technology stack for the end-to-end customer loan journey is under development, and is expected to be ready by February 2027. "Our focus is on retail segment, customer acquisition and referral lending, and we are taking right strides and at a steady pace in each of these. This is a conscious strategy in light of our small finance bank transition. Our capital position continues to remain comfortably above the regulatory requirement

for the proposed SFB," said Merchant. FPBL's Interim CEO emphasised that the bank's objective remains to build a differentiated SFB anchored on three enduring competitive strengths. "The first is strong liability franchise that gives the bank structural advantage in terms of cost of funds. Second is predominantly secured and asset-light lending model powered by huge network covering more than 95 per cent of India's pin code, enabling efficient customer acquisition, disciplined underwriting and scalable growth. And third is technology-led operation platform built around Finacle, AI-enabled lending capabilities and robust digital infrastructure that will support innovation and operational efficiency," he added.

40% fall in ADAS hardware cost brings safety tech closer to mass-market cars

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Level 2 advanced driver-assistance systems (ADAS) features such as automatic emergency braking, adaptive cruise control, lane-keeping assistance and blind-spot warning, which require the driver to remain attentive and in control, have trickled down from ₹30 lakh-plus vehicles to upper variants of Honda Amaze compact sedan priced at around ₹9.39 lakh and Mahindra XUV 3XO sub-four-metre compact SUV priced at ₹11.99 lakh.

Hanif Qureshi, Additional Secretary in the Ministry of Heavy Industries, said the changing economics could broaden access to automotive safety technology. "Hardware costs are dropping, solid-state LiDAR units moving below \$400 and camera modules falling under \$20. This means safety features once reserved for luxury vehicles are now available across mass-market segments," said Qureshi.

CHEAPER HARDWARE
Over the past year, solid-state LiDAR prices have fallen 40-45 per cent to \$350-400 from \$600-800, short-range radar 35-40 per cent to \$16-20 from \$28-35 and HD camera modules 35-40 per cent to \$12-18 from \$22-30. High-compute ADAS controllers have become about 30 per cent cheaper at \$250-350, down from \$450-600. The decline is part of a longer technology-cost reset. Early mechanical LiDAR

units could cost roughly \$5,000-10,000 or more in 2019-20, compared with about \$350-400 for newer solid-state units today, though the technologies aren't strictly comparable. Lower costs give automakers more room to offer active-safety technology on high-volume models, while buyers could get ADAS without paying for the most expensive trims. Component suppliers could benefit, too: falling unit prices can be offset by increasing camera, radar, electronics and software content per vehicle.

units could cost roughly \$5,000-10,000 or more in 2019-20, compared with about \$350-400 for newer solid-state units today, though the technologies aren't strictly comparable. Lower costs give automakers more room to offer active-safety technology on high-volume models, while buyers could get ADAS without paying for the most expensive trims. Component suppliers could benefit, too: falling unit prices can be offset by increasing camera, radar, electronics and software content per vehicle. Another incentive Bharat NCAP adds another incentive. As active-safety technologies assume a greater role in India's vehicle-safety assessment, cheaper sensors and computing could lower the cost of equipping high-volume models, with functions such as AEB, and help manufac-

AEPC urges Commerce Minister to take measures to regulate cotton yarn export

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Apparel Export Promotion Council (AEPC) has urged Union Minister of Commerce and Industry Piyush Goyal to consider taking suitable measures to regulate the export of cotton yarn, particularly of 20s count and above. This is due to the sharp increase in yarn prices and the growing pressure on the competitiveness of India's apparel export industry. Cotton yarn prices have increased by around 60 per cent, from approximately ₹250 per kg in early 2026, to around ₹400 per kg now, further increasing pressure on the apparel manufacturing value chain. Rising costs of other raw materials and fuel are also aggravating the situation, said AEPC Chairman A



Sakthivel in a letter to the Minister. The council also sought the intervention and support of Union Minister of Textiles Giriraj Singh. It highlighted that a substantial quantity of cotton had moved from farmers to traders, contributing to hoarding and speculative practices in the market.

US RESTRICTIONS
Sakthivel also highlighted the increase in exports of Indian cotton and cotton yarn

Army to procure 100 Javelin missiles worth \$93 m from the US

Dalip Singh
New Delhi

The Army has signed a US foreign military sales letter of offer and acceptance (LoA) to procure nearly 100 FGM-148 Javelin anti-tank guided missile systems worth \$93 million.

The move comes after an approval was granted by the US State Department in November last year. Through the emergency procurement route, the Army will acquire nearly 100 Javelin missiles, one fly-to-buy round, 25 command-launch units, training aids, simulation rounds, spare parts and full lifecycle support.

US Ambassador Sergio Gor announced on Friday that India plans to buy the battle-tested Javelin anti-tank system. "Just as @secwar (Secretary, War, Pete Hegseth) highlighted at the May 2026 Shangri-La Dialogue, this is a great step forward in the US-India defence relationship and opens the door to co-production possibilities," Gor wrote on X, adding that the engagement between our two nations is at "record high levels".

The US embassy in a statement on Friday, too, said that the agreement opens discussions on "mutually beneficial co-production" of Javelin — manufactured by the Javelin Joint Venture, a partnership between RTX and Lockheed Martin — and additional opportunities to strengthen the defence industrial bases of both countries.

DRDO WEAPON
The acquisition decision comes at a time when DRDO's similar shoulder-fired anti-tank weapon, the

The missiles are designed for use against a wide array of targets, including armoured vehicles and fortified positions

man-portable anti-tank guided missile (MPATGM), is undergoing final user evaluation trial before mass production. The MPATGM is a third generation fire-and-forget missile. With the signing of the LoA, the US Embassy stated that India has become a customer of the Javelin system, an advanced, medium-range, anti-tank guided missile used by the their army, US Marine Corps and numerous international customers. It's designed for use against a wide array of targets, including armoured vehicles and fortified positions. The embassy said that the landmark signature further strengthens the US-India Major Defence Partnership by demonstrating the depth of ongoing US support to the Indian Army. This is one among the list of defence procurements the Trump administration has been advocating for long.

MORE IN THE LINE
According to a notification issued by the US Defence Security Cooperation Agency in November 2025, India also requested up to 216 M982A1 Excalibur tactical projectiles with an estimated cost of \$47.1 million. The Excalibur is a GPS-guided, extended-range artillery round known for its high precision. It was used by the Army during Operation Sindoor to target Pakistani installations.

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E-mail: hoecshare@hoec.com, Website: www.hoec.com

CIAL/COMM/SHW/76 TENDER NOTICE 29.08.2026
Online Item Rate E-tenders are invited from reputed agencies for the work mentioned below at Cochin International Airport.

Sl.No	Name of Work	Estimate Amount	EMD	Completion Period
1	SITC of Hyper-Converged Infrastructure Solution at CIAL	Rs. 35 Crores Inclusive of taxes	Rs.20 Lakh	6 Months

Interested firms may register themselves on the online E-Tendering portal <https://etenders.kerala.gov.in> and then download the Tender documents. For eligibility criteria and other details, visit our website www.cial.aero.
Sd/-
Managing Director

HINDUSTAN OIL EXPLORATION COMPANY LIMITED
(CIN: L1100G11996PLC028880)
Registered Office: 'HOEC House', Tandallaj Road, Vadodara - 390 020, Gujarat, India
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E-mail: hoecshare@hoec.com, Website: www.hoec.com

42ND ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING OF THE COMPANY
Members are requested to note that the 42nd Annual General Meeting (AGM) of the Company will be held on Friday, the 25th day of September 2026 at 11.00 a.m. through Video Conferencing (VC) / Other Audio-Visual Means (OAVM), in compliance with the Circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) the latest being General Circular No. 03/2025 dated 22/09/2025 and SEBI Circular No. SEBI/HO/CFD/CFD-PoD-2/P/CIR/2024/133 dated October 3, 2024 issued by SEBI (hereinafter collectively referred to as "the Circulars") and all other applicable laws, to transact the businesses that will be set forth in the Notice of the 42nd AGM.
In compliance with the above Circulars, the Notice of the AGM along with the Annual Report of FY 2025-26 will be sent only through electronic mode to those Members whose e-mail IDs are registered with the Company / Depository Participants.
A letter providing the web-link and exact path where complete details of Annual Report of FY 2025-26 is available will be sent to Members who have not registered their e-mail IDs.
Members may note that the Notice and Annual Report of FY 2025-26 will also be made available on the Company's website www.hoec.com, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at www.bseindia.com and www.nseindia.com respectively, and on the website of CDSL www.evotingindia.com.
Members who have not registered their e-mail addresses so far are requested to register the same in respect of shares held in dematerialized form with the Depository through their Depository Participants (DP) and in respect of shares held in physical form by writing to the Registrar & Share Transfer Agent (RTA) - MUFG Intime India Private Limited (formerly known as Link Intime India Private Limited), "Geetakunj", 1, Bhakti Nagar Society, Behind ABS Tower, Old Padra Road, Vadodra, Gujarat 390015; Email id: vadodara@in.mpmis.mufg.com or by submitting the KYC forms at <https://web.in.mpmis.mufg.com/KYC-downloads.html>
The Company will provide the facility to its Members to exercise their right to vote by electronic means, both through remote e-voting and e-voting at the AGM. The detailed instructions on the process of e-voting will be provided as part of the Notice of the 42nd AGM.
By order of the Board of Directors
For **HINDUSTAN OIL EXPLORATION COMPANY LIMITED**
Sd/-
G. Josephin Daisy
Company Secretary

Place : Chennai
Date : August 29, 2026

TIGHTENING THE SCREWS. Centre tells mills not to sell to unregistered traders; units have to sell 40% of fortnightly allocation in the first week

Gold prices were little changed on Friday as investors held off on making large bets ahead of Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh's speech. Spot gold was down 0.02 per cent at \$4,600.07 per ounce by 1302 GMT. US gold futures for December delivery fell 0.3 per cent to \$4,642.90. REUTERS

DELIVERY WINDOW

Among major cities, sugar sold at ₹58 a kg in Mumbai and ₹59 in Kolkata. Prices in

“The increase in area

TUR EDGES UP

Tur acreage rose marginally

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QUICKLY.

Task force formed to review exam reforms

New Delhi A high-powered task force, set up by the Centre amid the recent protests by student bodies over paper leak allegations at Jantar Mantar, on Friday invited public suggestions on comprehensive reforms in public examinations, including measures to fix accountability and strengthen institutional arrangements. The Centre in July announced the constitution of the six-member high-powered task force (HPTF) chaired by Infosys Co-founder Nandan Nilekani to recommend reforms related to the security, design and governance of public exam. PTI

Govt appoints 2 Directors, Joint Director to NTA

New Delhi: The Centre has appointed IPS officer Ravi Kumar Singh and Prasanna Venkatesh V, an IAS officer, as Directors and IRS officer Amit Samdariya as Joint Director to the National Testing Agency (NTA), according to the Personnel Ministry. The agency has been drawing flak for issues related to the National Eligibility-cum-Entrance Test paper leak, among other concerns. PTI

CII panel moots creation of GFI to mobilise funds

Our Bureau
New Delhi

India should set up a dedicated Green Finance Institution (GFI) to mobilise capital at scale for green infrastructure and industrial transition, alongside measures to make the country's carbon market more predictable as well as to strengthen corporate sustainability disclosures, a corporate panel on sustainability has proposed.

According to the India Sustainability Taskforce, constituted by the Confederation of Indian Industry (CII), the GFI should operate as an impact-oriented blended-finance platform rather than a conventional public-sector lender.

RECOMMENDATIONS
In its key recommendations, the taskforce said that the GFI should structure transactions, provide credit guarantees and other risk-sharing instruments, anchor funds and crowd in domestic and global private investment into climate-aligned



projects. The proposed institution would focus particularly on mid-sized companies and MSMEs, which often face higher costs of capital and weaker access to finance.

As per the recommendations, green credit for these segments should primarily flow through banks and NBFCs using standardised taxonomy-aligned products, supported by partial credit guarantees or first-loss cover from the GFI.

DRIVING INVESTMENTS
The taskforce has set an in-

dicative figure for the GFI to catalyse up to \$1 trillion of investment over five to 10 years, subject to its institutional design, capitalisation and project pipeline.

Accordingly, the institution could support renewable energy, energy storage, clean transportation, industrial decarbonisation, green hydrogen, offshore wind and MSME supply-chain transition, among other areas.

Besides, the taskforce has proposed a legally authorised mechanism for public carbon-related revenue.

Furthermore, it said that where the government establishes a specifically designated GFI-linked mechanism, it has recommended allocating 100 per cent of the net legally appropriable proceeds to the GFI, while keeping such public revenue separate from the value generated through private carbon-credit trading.

CARBON MARKETS
On carbon markets, the taskforce has recommended retaining the existing emissions-intensity baseline-and-credit architecture, while progressively tighten-

ing sectoral targets. It has called for publication of the emissions-intensity target trajectory beyond 2026-27, enabling companies to assess future certificate requirements and plan investments.

CLIMATE FINANCE
Additionally, the taskforce has called for finalising India's 'Climate Finance Taxonomy', including its governance framework and first set of sectoral annexures.

This would provide a common reference for banks, investors, insurers and companies to determine which activities qualify as climate-aligned and help direct finance towards them.

In addition, the taskforce has proposed strengthening the 'Business Responsibility and Sustainability Reporting' (BRSR) framework and progressively aligning it with international standards.

This includes digital iXBRL reporting, a phased assurance roadmap and greater disclosure of corporate transition plans, emissions targets and capital expenditure linked to decarbonisation.

Govt expects 25,000 registrations under Parivartan scheme by October

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways expects 25,000 beneficiary registrations under the Parivartan (Programme for Accelerated Renewal and Incentivisation of Vehicle Assets for Reducing Transport Air Pollution and Network Emissions) scheme.

It was launched last month to phase out polluting commercial vehicles in Delhi-NCR.

As many as 1,450 old truck and bus owners have so far registered under the scheme since its launch on July 14, Road Transport and Highways Secretary V Umashankar said on Friday. Addressing a press conference, Umashankar said the Ministry expects more than 25,000 old commercial truck and bus owners to register under the Parivartan scheme by October.

There are over 2 lakh trucks and buses conforming to Bharat Stage (BS)-IV or prior emission norms, registered in the National Capital Territory of Delhi, according to the Ministry. The scheme was approved by the Union Cabinet on June 3 with a total outlay of ₹9,585 crore, including ₹5,041 crore

The scheme was launched last month to phase out polluting commercial vehicles in Delhi-NCR

as Central government support.

The Ministry of Road Transport and Highways (MoRTH) is implementing the scheme through the National Capital Region Planning Board (NCRPB).

MULTIPLE INCENTIVES
The beneficiaries will receive multiple incentives, including motor vehicle tax concessions, registration fee waivers, 5 per cent interest subvention on vehicle loans, a minimum 8 per cent discount from original equipment manufacturers (OEMs), monthly fuel voucher support for eligible diesel and CNG replacement vehicles, and one-time financial assistance for electric replacement vehicles and Certificate of Deposit (CoD) trading.

Rajasthan, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and Delhi have notified a 10-year motor vehicle tax concession and registration fee waiver for eligible new vehicles under the

scheme. As many as 15 OEMs, accounting for over 95 per cent of the commercial vehicle market, have signed agreements with MoRTH to provide the mandated discounts for replacement of old commercial vehicles. For buyers opting for BS-VI diesel or CNG vehicles, the scheme provides monthly fuel vouchers ranging from ₹1,200 to ₹4,800 for five years, depending on the vehicle category.

The Parivartan scheme aims to reduce vehicular pollution in Delhi-NCR. The scheme will be implemented through an integrated digital platform linked with VAHAN, V-Scrap, DigiELV, PFMS, participating lenders and fuel voucher systems to ensure transparent and seamless delivery of benefits.

TO ADVERTISE
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thehindu businessline.

Dear Shareholders,

It gives me immense pleasure to welcome you all for the 63rd Annual General Meeting of Hindustan Aeronautics Limited.

I am pleased to share your Company's annual performance highlights for the Financial Year 2025-26. During the year, despite of supply chain disruption caused by the current global scenario, the Company's performance was impressive and considerable progress was made in terms of revenue, profitability, order book and productivity.

This achievement would not have been possible without the strong commitment of our people, the trust of our esteemed customers, support from the government and backing of our shareholders. I, on behalf of the Board of Directors, sincerely thank each one of you for your invaluable contributions.



Financial and Performance Highlights of the Year

On the financial parameters, the Company recorded an all-time high turnover of Rs. 31,792 Crore for FY 2025-26 driven by consistent order execution and growing demand for indigenous defence platforms. The Company's operational resilience and agility led to a 6% growth from the previous year, despite disruptions in the supply chain. The Profit Before Tax for the year increased by 12% to Rs. 12,112 Crore from Rs. 10,820 Crore in the previous year. The Profit after Tax (PAT) increased by 9% to Rs. 9,076 Crore from Rs. 8,317 Crore in the previous year. As of March 2026, the order book position of the Company stood at a healthy Rs. 2,54,538 Crore.

The Company has paid an interim dividend of Rs.35/- per equity share of face value of Rs.5/- each for the FY 2025-26, totalling to Rs. 2,341 Crore. Further, the Board of Directors of the Company has recommended a final dividend of Rs.10/- per share of Rs.5/- each for approval of shareholders, with a cash outflow of Rs. 669 Crore. On approval of shareholders, the total cash outflow for payment of dividend for the FY 2025-26 would be Rs. 3,010 Crore.

The Company incurred Capital Expenditure (CAPEX) of Rs. 2,465 Crore during FY 2025-26 (PY Rs. 2,026 Crore). The investments are mainly channelised towards Green Field Helicopter Project at Tumakuru, augmentation of facilities of LCA, ROH of SU-30, ROH of AL-31FP Engine, IT Infrastructure, besides the regular replacement and rationalisation of the existing facilities etc on the infrastructure development front and on the projects like IMRH, CATS, UHM, Civil ALH & LUH on the Research & Development front.

Aligned with its strategic objectives, the Company has drawn up a robust capital expenditure (CAPEX) plan for the next five years, with a projected investment of around Rs.14,000 Crore. The planned investment will primarily be directed towards expanding manufacturing capacities and establishing Repair and Overhaul (ROH) facilities for various platforms, strengthening the Company's production capabilities and long-term growth.



Research and Development (R&D)

The Company has incurred an expenditure of Rs. 2,794 Crore on R&D during FY 2025-26, which is 8.79 % of the turnover. The Company also transferred a sum of Rs. 945 Crore to R&D reserve for contribution to R&D corpus.

Significant Achievements

Your Company accomplished several significant achievements during the year, some of which are highlighted as under:

- To enhance the production capacity of LCA Mk1A, a 3rd production line was established at HAL Nasik.

— A Maharatna CPSE —

Ravi K
Chairman and Managing Director

CMD's Speech at 63rd Annual General Meeting held on August 28, 2026

- Indigenously designed & developed Advanced Light Helicopter (ALH) Dhruv-MG took maiden flight in presence of Hon'ble Minister of the Civil Aviation.
- The maiden sortie of the first series production Hindustan Turbo Trainer-40 (HTT-40) aircraft successfully completed.
- Certification for 'Indigenous manufacturing of Shakti Civil Engine' from the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA) was received.
- Contributed to ISRO's successful launch of LVM3-M5/CMS-03 mission and LVM3-M6 mission that deployed the massive Blue Bird Block 2 satellite, by on-time supply of space worthy hardware.
- Signed the SSLV Technology Transfer Agreement with ISRO, IN-SPaCe & NSIL, securing a non-exclusive license to manufacture the SSLV.
- Ab-initio designed & developed technologies for LCA Mk2 platform.
 - Data Acquisition technology has been introduced in Electrical LRUs i.e., AC & DC Power Management Units for Contactor status, AC/DC source Input current, Essential Bus Voltage, Frequency etc. and their transmission on RS422 line for health monitoring and recording purpose.
 - Optical Level Sensing technology has been developed for aircraft Fuel Tanks Low Level & High-Level warning indication to improve the accuracy, in place of existing capacitance based sensing.

Future Outlook

The Company is intensifying efforts to expand its global footprint through exports and strategic collaborations with international partners. Emerging opportunities in areas such as unmanned systems, advanced materials, digital manufacturing, and space applications are expected to open new growth avenues.

The Company is poised to sustain its growth trajectory and reinforce its position as a key enabler of India's aerospace and defence capabilities while progressively enhancing its competitiveness in the global market.

Human Resource Development

People remain HAL's most enduring institutional asset. In the year 2025-26, Human Resources focused on strengthening organisational effectiveness, deepening employee engagement, and building the workforce capabilities for our expanding programmes demand. All HR manuals were consolidated into a unified Corporate HR Manual, accessible through a dedicated digital HR Bot, simplifying governance and improving the employee experience. Service recognition frameworks, travel entitlements, medical benefits for dependent parents, and separation settlements were comprehensively revised, reflecting our sustained commitment to employee welfare. A renegotiated Incentive Scheme for Workmen, reinforces the link between performance and reward, sustaining a stable industrial relation environment. HAL's recognition by Department of Public Enterprises (DPE) as a Mentor Organisation for Succession Planning and Leadership Development across peer DPSUs affirms the maturity of our people practices.

Building capability for the future, the Leadership Development Programme continues to groom our senior leadership pipeline, while the Sponsorship programmes deepens the technical foundation. HAL Management Academy, now an Authorised Training Partner of the Project Management Institute, USA, has broadened its reach considerably. Project Management Teams with certified professionals have been constituted across the Company to drive focused execution and coordination across HAL's growing portfolio of projects. A new Flight Test Engineer Scheme builds the specialised capability in-house,

and initiatives such as Mission Abhyudaya and the Critical Skill Transfer programme are systematically preparing our workforce for smart manufacturing and next-generation aerospace demands.

Corporate Governance

Your Company always strives to conduct the business with integrity, in an ethical and transparent manner to attain the highest standard of Corporate Governance practice in the letter & spirit by framing & implementing various policies & procedures mandated under the Companies Act and SEBI (LODR) Regulations, DPE Guidelines, Public Procurement Policy, CVC Guidelines, MoD directives issued from time to time. The Company has complied with the Guidelines on Corporate Governance framed by the Department of Public Enterprises (DPE) and SEBI Listing Regulations except for the appointment of the requisite number of Independent Directors including Woman Independent Director which led to the non-compliance related to composition of the Board and some of its Committee as indicated in the Corporate Governance Report, forms part of Annual Report. The Company has established systems and procedures to ensure that its Board of Directors is well informed about the policies of the company, to enable them to discharge their responsibilities and to enhance the overall value of all stakeholders. Your company has been continuously rated 'Excellent' grade for the past 24 years with respect to MoU signed with Department of Public Enterprises.



Environment, Social and Governance (ESG)

HAL's commitment to ESG is evident through its focus on environmental responsibility, social development, and robust corporate governance. From reducing water consumption and implementing emission control technologies to its impactful CSR initiatives, and dedication to employee well-being, the Company is actively shaping a sustainable future for India, its stakeholders, and its workforce.

During the year, 200 KW capacity roof top solar power plants have been installed at various locations of the Company. The Company has installed a cumulative capacity of 50.15 MW capacity Renewable Energy (RE) plants out of which 14.7 MW is from wind and balance from solar (ground & roof top). The Company also procured Green power to the tune of 140 Lakh kWh from DISCOMS. The Company has met around 40% of its electricity requirement from RE sources in FY 2025-26.

The Renewable Energy consumption has avoided around 71000 Tons of CO₂e emissions in the reporting year thereby contributing to the mitigation of climate change.

Corporate Social Responsibility and Sustainability Development

Your Company is committed to its social responsibility. In this endeavour, the Company has undertaken various CSR programmes and projects, towards integrating our social and business goals in a sustainable manner in line with Schedule VII of the Companies Act, 2013. During the year, an amount of Rs. 181 Crore has been spent under CSR against the CSR budget/ obligation of Rs. 169 Crore.

Acknowledgement

I take this opportunity to extend my sincere gratitude to the Department of Defence Production, Defence Acquisition Council, Defence Finance, Department of Civil Aviation and our valuable customers viz., the Indian Air Force, Indian Army, Indian Navy, Indian Coast Guard, Border Security Force, ISRO, other Global Aviation Companies and private industry.

I thank DGAOA, DRDO, CEMILAC, Principal Controller of Defence Accounts, Principal Director of Commercial Audit, C&AG, Auditors, Bankers, Legal Advisors, Collaborators, Suppliers, Shareholders and other Agencies and acknowledge their contributions to the Company's achievements.

I am grateful, once again, to the members of the Board for their valuable guidance and acknowledge the immense contribution and dedication of the employees at all levels.

JAI HIND

Sd/-
(**Ravi K**)
Chairman and Managing Director
with Addl. Charge of Director (Operations)

QUICKLY.

BioNTech to terminate mRNA cancer vaccine trial



BioNTech SE said on Friday it has decided to terminate the mid-stage trial of its experimental mRNA-based cancer vaccine. The trial was evaluating it as an adjuvant monotherapy in patients with high-risk stage II or stage III colorectal cancer whose tumours had been surgically removed but remained ctDNA-positive. REUTERS

Google changes policy in EU to avert antitrust fine

Alphabet's Google on Friday said it had changed its spam policy in Europe to address EU concerns that could have resulted in an antitrust fine. The US tech giant found itself in EU regulators' crosshairs after publishers complained about its site reputation abuse policy. REUTERS

Advent, Stripe likely to drop out of PayPal buyout

A consortium of buyout firm Advent and payment processor Stripe has decided to abandon its pursuit of fintech pioneer PayPal, Bloomberg News reported on Thursday. The payments company received a \$60.50-per-share bid from Stripe and private equity firm Advent International, which valued it at more than \$53 billion in July. The offer is a fraction of the roughly \$360 billion valuation PayPal commanded in 2021. PayPal's board saw the bid as inadequate and said it faced regulatory and financing hurdles. REUTERS

Nepal floods: 21 Indians arrive but 320 still remain ‘uncontactable’

HELPING HAND. India is ready to extend all possible assistance to Kathmandu in its rescue efforts: MEA

Press Trust of India
New Delhi

At least 320 Indians remain missing and around 400 others are stranded on the Chinese side following devastating flash floods along the Nepal-Tibet border and India is ready to extend all possible help to Kathmandu in its rescue efforts, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Friday.

MEA spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said 96 Indian nationals who were stranded on the Chinese side have safely crossed over to Nepal by the land route.

Twenty-one Indians arrived in New Delhi on Friday afternoon, a day after they reached Kathmandu from the flood-affected areas of Nepal, he said.

The Indian nationals from Tamil Nadu were received at the airport in the national capital by External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar.

RESCUE OPERATIONS

The death toll from Wednesday's flash floods in Nepal rose to 579 with more bodies recovered as search and rescue operations continued, according to latest details shared by Nepalese authorities. As many as 2,000 are still missing.

"As far as the number of people (Indians) whom we are not able to contact or who are missing, the figure at this point in time is 320," Jaiswal said.

"There are also around 100 persons of Indian origin who remained uncontactable. These are people of Indian origin who may have gone for Kailash Mansarovar Yatra, but they hold other nationalities," he said.



SAFE RETURN. External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar greeting a group of 21 tourists from Tamil Nadu, who returned from Nepal, at the New Delhi airport

Jaiswal said 400 Indians are stranded on the Chinese side but they are safe.

In a related development, Jaishankar held a high-level meeting with senior officials and reviewed the situation in Nepal with a focus on tracking the status of missing Indians.

Indian envoys to Kathmandu and Beijing also joined the meeting through virtual mode.

India dispatched a third tranche of 10 tonnes of relief supplies to flood-ravaged Nepal, alongside an 11-member team of doctors and paramedics, as well as a reconnaissance crew to assess tunnel rescue operations.

New Delhi had on Wednesday dispatched 10 tonnes of humanitarian assistance and disaster relief materials to the neighbouring country while another consignment of 37.5 tonnes of relief supplies was sent on Thursday.

"A third flight carrying 10 tonnes of humanitarian assistance has departed for

Kathmandu. The assistance includes portable generator sets, dignity kits, food packets and water purification tablets," Jaishankar said.

"An 11-member team of doctors, paramedics & Recce team for Tunnel rescue operations is also on-board. India continues to support Nepal's ongoing relief and rescue efforts," he said on social media.

Meanwhile, parts of Bihar faced the threat of a deluge as water levels in the Ganga, Gandak, Kosi and Burhi Gandak rivers showed a rising trend following the devastating flash floods.

EXCESS WATER

A senior official said that excess water brought in by the flash floods has caused the Gandak river to swell, forcing

authorities to open all 36 gates of a barrage over the river in Valmiki Nagar.

Around 1.02 lakh cusecs of water were released from the Gandak Barrage by 5 pm on Friday.

As many as 290 people from Maharashtra are stranded but confirmed safe in various parts of Nepal following the devastating flash floods while 60 tourists are still untraceable, a state government official said on Friday.

Further, 105 people from Maharashtra who were in Nepal at the time of the tragedy are on their way back to India, said the State Disaster Management Department official.

The European Union on Friday promised two million euros (\$2.3 mn) in aid for Nepal after devastating floods on the country's border with Tibet swept away entire villages, killing hundreds of people.

European Commission chief Ursula von der Leyen wrote on X that the "immediate humanitarian aid" would help "deliver life-saving assistance to families and communities hit hardest."

Flash flood disaster caused by glacier collapse: China

Press Trust of India
Beijing

China on Friday said the collapse of a high-altitude glacier in Nepal triggered the massive flash flood disaster that engulfed the Tibet-Nepal border.

Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Lin Jian, said, "We noted that experts and official institutions of China and Nepal have made preliminary

assessment on the cause of the disaster. According to their analysis, the disaster has been triggered by a collapse of a high-altitude glacier in Nepal."

Scientists are also examining how a possible glacial collapse and ice-rock avalanche may have triggered the devastating flash floods, with preliminary assessments indicating that debris may have temporarily blocked Lhende river and created a landslide dam that subsequently gave way.

Initial speculation after the sudden surge near the Nepal-Tibet border crossing in Rasuwagadhi included a glacial lake outburst flood and an avalanche.

However, scientists analysing satellite imagery now believe a large mass of ice and rock may have fallen into Lhende river, temporarily blocking its flow and creating a landslide dam that subsequently gave way, The Kathmandu Post newspaper reported.

Praggnanandhaa beats Carauna to become first Indian to clinch Grand Chess Tour title

Press Trust of India
St Louis

Grandmaster R Praggnanandhaa became the first Indian to clinch the Grand Chess Tour (GCT) title, beating Fabiano Caruana of the US with a stunning comeback win in the grand finale.

Praggnanandhaa made a remarkable turnaround after trailing Caruana by six points at the start of the day at the Saint Louis Chess Club here. The Indian eventually prevailed 15-13 to win his maiden GCT title and pocket \$2,00,000 as the winning purse.

The title win also guaranteed Praggnanandhaa a spot in the next year's GCT along with Caruana and another American Wesley So, who



PRESTIGIOUS WIN. Grandmaster R Praggnanandhaa analyses his second round match against US's Fabiano Caruana in the Grand Chess Tour at the Saint Louis Chess Club on Friday

defeated Vincent Keymer of Germany 18-12 to take the third place. "Honestly, I didn't think I had many chances today," Praggnanandhaa told Chess.com.

"It's not every day that you can get one win from Fabi, but to get two, it was important in the rapid." The 21-

year-old started the day six points behind, but pulled another rabbit out of the hat and took a lead of two points after winning both the rapid games (four points to winner per game).

It was even-stevens in the subsequent four games of blitz, with Praggnanandhaa

and Caruana winning one each while the remaining two were drawn.

RAPID GAMES

The two-point lead at the end of the rapid games proved decisive for the Indian Grandmaster.

The first game of the blitz section was a drawn affair before Caruana won the second to level the scores at 12-12.

A determined Praggnanandhaa prevailed over his opponent in the third game to restore his two-point lead (14-12).

Had Caruana won the last blitz game, he would have forced two more games with the peculiar time control, followed by armageddon.

But, a draw was enough for Praggnanandhaa to win the match, and he did just that to seal a famous title.

Rising exports lift BYD profit for first time in 5 quarters

Bloomberg

BYD's profit rose for the first time in five quarters as surging exports and demand for some of its pricier models helped the world's largest electric-vehicle maker overcome a downturn in China.

Second-quarter net income climbed 30 per cent from a year earlier to 8.2 billion yuan (\$1.2 billion), according to figures derived from first-half earnings reported on Friday.

Earnings were slightly above the average analyst estimate compiled by Bloomberg, while revenue unexpectedly slipped about 3 per cent to 194.6 billion yuan.

The results bring a much-needed boost for BYD as intense competition with Xiaomi and Xpeng resulted in a year-long profit slump.

IndiGo announces investment in Sarvam, steps up AI focus

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

IndiGo has announced investment in Sarvam AI as part of its broader strategy to use AI-led technologies for improved customer experience and innovation.

The investment was made through IndiGo Ventures, the airline's venture capital arm, that has previously invested in aerospace manufacturing and urban mobility start-ups.

IndiGo Venture's investment is a part of Sarvam's Series B funding in which the Bengaluru-based AI start-up raised around ₹698 crore from various investors. IndiGo Venture's committed around ₹30 crore, according to Sarvam's filing.

In a statement, IndiGo



said the investment builds on the existing relationship between the two companies.

WORKFORCE

"Artificial Intelligence is fast becoming a foundational capability for the aviation industry, reshaping customer experience, workforce productivity and operational decision-making. Our partnership with Sarvam gives IndiGo access to cutting-edge AI capabilities, built in India, and tailored to the needs of the market. By combining these technologies with our operational ex-

pertise and scale, we can accelerate innovation while maximising value for our customers, employees, and other stakeholders," Neetan Chopra, Chief Digital and Information Officer, IndiGo, said.

"IndiGo brings the domain depth and scale needed to identify where AI can create real value. Together, we can develop systems that are useful in production and build a stronger template for enterprise AI in India," said Pratyush Kumar, Co-founder, Sarvam AI.

IndiGo and Sarvam will continue to develop and evaluate applications across customer experience, employee productivity and airline operations, with the ability to expand successful use cases across the airline's network, the airline said.

Amid AI automation, firms look for polymath engineers

Sanjana B
Bengaluru

AI is reshaping what companies want from engineers, with deep technical expertise alone increasingly giving way to 'polymath' talent that can bridge technology, business and multiple disciplines, industry experts said.

For instance, in an earlier interaction with businessline, Rob Vatter, Executive President & Global Business Head — Aerospace & Defence at Quest Global, said the IT industry is betting on polymath engineers, or multi-skilled problem solvers, who blend technical depth with creative breadth, as AI reshapes traditional roles and demands a new breed of talent.

He described a polymath as someone who brings together multiple skills across different domains.

"Quest Global wants to develop that kind of engineer, especially due to the

widening demand-supply gap in talent. With AI taking over routine and repetitive tasks, engineers now need to operate at a higher level of productivity, making cross-domain capability essential," he said.

CHANGING ECONOMICS

Anuj Agrawal, Founder & CEO of Zyoin Group, attributed this rise in demand to three factors. First, business problems started crossing boundaries faster than organisations could restructure themselves. Any project today touches engineering, data, cloud, security, domain regulation, and commercial outcome.

The second is AI, which has enabled an individual to have the leverage that once required a team. This changes the economics of hiring permanently.

The third is scarcity, since few companies can afford a separate specialist for every capability that emerged in



the last 30 months. "A polymath is not someone who knows 10 subjects superficially, but someone with one or two areas of genuine depth, enough understanding of adjacent disciplines to connect them without an interpreter in the room, and the curiosity and AI fluency to learn whatever the problem demands next," Agrawal said.

DRIVING DEMAND

According to TeamLease Digital, even as AI has made highly specialised, repetitive technical work cheaper and easier to automate, more than 60 per cent of enter-

prise leaders say their biggest challenge is solving problems across different functions.

This is driving demand for hybrid roles such as forward deployed engineers (FDEs) and GTM engineers, who combine technical skills with business understanding and use AI tools to turn insights into strategy.

"Since ChatGPT's launch, structured, repetitive cognitive roles have fallen 10-15 per cent, while analytical, creative, and leadership-intensive work has grown 20-22 per cent. AI is absorbing task-based specialism, and the market is shifting toward T-shaped talent: professionals with core depth who can move fluidly across strategy, technology and execution," Neeti Sharma, CEO, TeamLease Digital, observed.

Alongside, job descriptions are evolving. Titles and tenure are giving way to skills and outcomes. AI fluency is now written into finance, HR, marketing, and op-

erations briefs, not just technical ones. "The qualifications section is shrinking while the ambiguity section grows; phrases like 'comfortable operating across functions' and 'able to own end-to-end' have become standard," he pointed out.

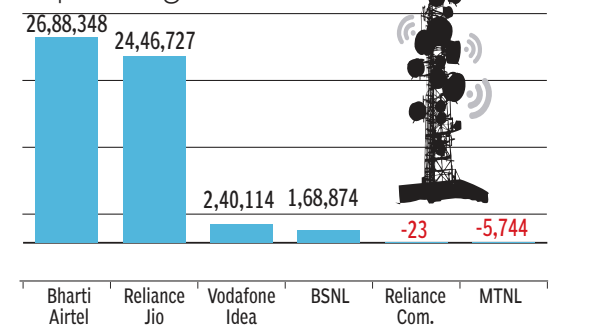
PRODUCT MANAGERS

Among the roles seeing the strongest demand for polymathic talent are engineering and product — particularly AI and platform engineering. Product managers are now expected to hold customer, technology, data, and unit economics simultaneously.

Others include solutions and transformation layer roles that sit where the customer problem meets domain, technology, implementation, and commercial outcome.

"Expect polymathic hiring to move from a differentiator to a baseline expectation within three to five years," Sharma added.

Expanding user base



"As per the information received from 1,562 operators for the month of July 2026, the total number of broadband subscribers increased from 1,087.50 million (108.75 crore) at the end of June 2026 to 1,094.48 million (109.44 crore) at the end of July 2026 with a monthly growth rate of 0.64 per cent," the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India said in its latest report.

For Bharti Airtel, net additions of 26.88 lakh mobile subscribers pushed its wireless subscriber base to 48.94 crore in July.

Reliance Jio added 24.46 lakh wireless users, taking its subscriber tally to 50.60 crore.

Vodafone Idea saw its mobile subscriber base rise to 19.90 crore, after gaining 2.40 lakh wireless subscribers.

Q	12/2020	12/2019	12/2018	12/2017	12/2016	12/2015	12/2014	12/2013	12/2012	12/2011	12/2010	12/2009	12/2008	12/2007	12/2006	12/2005	12/2004	12/2003	12/2002	12/2001	12/2000	11/2000	10/2000	9/2000	8/2000	7/2000	6/2000	5/2000	4/2000	3/2000	2/2000	1/2000	12/1999	11/1999	10/1999	9/1999	8/1999	7/1999	6/1999	5/1999	4/1999	3/1999	2/1999	1/1999	12/1998	11/1998	10/1998	9/1998	8/1998	7/1998	6/1998	5/1998	4/1998	3/1998	2/1998	1/1998	12/1997	11/1997	10/1997	9/1997	8/1997	7/1997	6/1997	5/1997	4/1997	3/1997	2/1997	1/1997	12/1996	11/1996	10/1996	9/1996	8/1996	7/1996	6/1996	5/1996	4/1996	3/1996	2/1996	1/1996	12/1995	11/1995	10/1995	9/1995	8/1995	7/1995	6/1995	5/1995	4/1995	3/1995	2/1995	1/1995	12/1994	11/1994	10/1994	9/1994	8/1994	7/1994	6/1994	5/1994	4/1994	3/1994	2/1994	1/1994	12/1993	11/1993	10/1993	9/1993	8/1993	7/1993	6/1993	5/1993	4/1993	3/1993	2/1993	1/1993	12/1992	11/1992	10/1992	9/1992	8/1992	7/1992	6/1992	5/1992	4/1992	3/1992	2/1992	1/1992	12/1991	11/1991	10/1991	9/1991	8/1991	7/1991	6/1991	5/1991	4/1991	3/1991	2/1991	1/1991	12/1990	11/1990	10/1990	9/1990	8/1990	7/1990	6/1990	5/1990	4/1990	3/1990	2/1990	1/1990	12/1989	11/1989	10/1989	9/1989	8/1989	7/1989	6/1989	5/1989	4/1989	3/1989	2/1989	1/1989	12/1988	11/1988	10/1988	9/1988	8/1988	7/1988	6/1988	5/1988	4/1988	3/1988	2/1988	1/1988	12/1987	11/1987	10/1987	9/1987	8/1987	7/1987	6/1987	5/1987	4/1987	3/1987	2/1987	1/1987	12/1986	11/1986	10/1986	9/1986	8/1986	7/1986	6/1986	5/1986	4/1986	3/1986	2/1986	1/1986	12/1985	11/1985	10/1985	9/1985	8/1985	7/1985	6/1985	5/1985	4/1985	3/1985	2/1985	1/1985	12/1984	11/1984	10/1984	9/1984	8/1984	7/1984	6/1984	5/1984	4/1984	3/1984	2/1984	1/1984	12/1983	11/1983	10/1983	9/1983	8/1983	7/1983	6/1983	5/1983	4/1983	3/1983	2/1983	1/1983	12/1982	11/1982	10/1982	9/1982	8/1982	7/1982	6/1982	5/1982	4/1982	3/1982	2/1982	1/1982	12/1981	11/1981	10/1981	9/1981	8/1981	7/1981	6/1981	5/1981	4/1981	3/1981	2/1981	1/1981	12/1980	11/1980	10/1980	9/1980	8/1980	7/1980	6/1980	5/1980	4/1980	3/1980	2/1980	1/1980	12/1979	11/1979	10/1979	9/1979	8/1979	7/1979	6/1979	5/1979	4/1979	3/1979	2/1979	1/1979	12/1978	11/1978	10/1978	9/1978	8/1978	7/1978	6/1978	5/1978	4/1978	3/1978	2/1978	1/1978	12/1977	11/1977	10/1977	9/1977	8/1977	7/1977	6/1977	5/1977	4/1977	3/1977	2/1977	1/1977	12/1976	11/1976	10/1976	9/1976	8/1976	7/1976	6/1976	5/1976	4/1976	3/1976	2/1976	1/1976	12/1975	11/1975	10/1975	9/1975	8/1975	7/1975	6/1975	5/1975	4/1975	3/1975	2/1975	1/1975	12/1974	11/1974	10/1974	9/1974	8/1974	7/1974	6/1974	5/1974	4/1974	3/1974	2/1974	1/1974	12/1973	11/1973	10/1973	9/1973	8/1973	7/1973	6/1973	5/1973	4/1973	3/1973	2/1973	1/1973	12/1972	11/1972	10/1972	9/1972	8/1972	7/1972	6/1972	5/1972	4/1972	3/1972	2/1972	1/1972	12/1971	11/1971	10/1971	9/1971	8/1971	7/1971	6/1971	5/1971	4/1971	3/1971	2/1971	1/1971	12/1970	11/1970	10/1970	9/1970	8/1970	7/1970	6/1970	5/1970	4/1970	3/1970	2/1970	1/1970	12/1969	11/1969	10/1969	9/1969	8/1969	7/1969	6/1969	5/1969	4/1969	3/1969	2/1969	1/1969	12/1968	11/1968	10/1968	9/1968	8/1968	7/1968	6/1968	5/1968	4/1968	3/1968	2/1968	1/1968	12/1967	11/1967	10/1967	9/1967	8/1967	7/1967	6/1967	5/1967	4/1967	3/1967	2/1967	1/1967	12/1966	11/1966	10/1966	9/1966	8/1966	7/1966	6/1966	5/1966	4/1966	3/1966	2/1966	1/1966	12/1965	11/1965	10/1965	9/1965	8/1965	7/1965	6/1965	5/1965	4/1965	3/1965	2/1965	1/1965	12/1964	11/1964	10/1964	9/1964	8/1964	7/1964	6/1964	5/1964	4/1964	3/1964	2/1964	1/1964	12/1963	11/1963	10/1963	9/1963	8/1963	7/1963	6/1963	5/1963	4/1963	3/1963	2/1963	1/1963	12/1962	11/1962	10/1962	9/1962	8/1962	7/1962	6/1962	5/1962	4/1962	3/1962	2/1962	1/1962	12/1961	11/1961	10/1961	9/1961	8/1961	7/1961	6/1961	5/1961	4/1961	3/1961	2/1961	1/1961	12/1960	11/1960	10/1960	9/1960	8/1960	7/1960	6/1960	5/1960	4/1960	3/1960	2/1960	1/1960	12/1959	11/1959	10/1959	9/1959	8/1959	7/1959	6/1959	5/1959	4/1959	3/1959	2/1959	1/1959	12/1958	11/1958	10/1958	9/1958	8/1958	7/1958	6/1958	5/1958	4/1958	3/1958	2/1958	1/1958	12/1957	11/1957	10/1957	9/1957	8/1957	7/1957	6/1957	5/1957	4/1957	3/1957	2/1957	1/1957	12/1956	11/1956	10/1956	9/1956	8/1956	7/1956	6/1956	5/1956	4/1956	3/1956	2/1956	1/1956	12/1955	11/1955	10/1955	9/1955	8/1955	7/1955	6/1955	5/1955	4/1955	3/1955	2/1955	1/1955	12/1954	11/1954	10/1954	9/1954	8/1954	7/1954	6/1954	5/1954	4/1954	3/1954	2/1954	1/1954	12/1953	11/1953	10/1953	9/1953	8/1953	7/1953	6/1953	5/1953	4/1953	3/1953	2/1953	1/1953	12/1952	11/1952	10/1952	9/1952	8/1952	7/1952	6/1952	5/1952	4/1952	3/1952	2/1952	1/1952	12/1951	11/1951	10/1951	9/1951	8/1951	7/1951	6/1951	5/1951	4/1951	3/1951	2/1951	1/1951	12/1950	11/1950	10/1950	9/1950	8/1950	7/1950	6/1950	5/1950	4/1950	3/1950	2/1950	1/1950	12/1949	11/1949	10/1949	9/1949	8/1949	7/1949	6/1949	5/1949	4/1949	3/1949	2/1949	1/1949	12/1948	11/1948	10/1948	9/1948	8/1948	7/1948	6/1948	5/1948	4/1948	3/1948	2/1948	1/1948	12/1947	11/1947	10/1947	9/1947	8/1947	7/1947	6/1947	5/1947	4/1947	3/1947	2/1947	1/1947	12/1946	11/1946	10/1946	9/1946	8/1946	7/1946	6/1946	5/1946	4/1946	3/1946	2/1946	1/1946	12/1945	11/1945	10/1945	9/1945	8/1945	7/1945	6/1945	5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